



MISSING WEAPONS

Military intelligence joins arms theft probe

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DIMMING HOPES

Shifting focus from search to rehabilitation, says Nepal PM

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NEW ROLE

IAF veteran first CEO of Ram Temple Trust

NEWS » PAGE 11

INDIA-CHINA TALKS

‘Early Harvest’ — larger but not necessarily safer

Hard questions remain on strategic concessions

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6



GRITTY SHOW

Zverev overcomes Sonego's challenge

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IN BRIEF



Order CBI probe into exam ‘scam’: Jharkhand BJP

PATNA
A BJP delegation met the Jharkhand Chief Secretary on Wednesday and submitted a memorandum demanding a CBI inquiry into alleged irregularities in government recruitment exams conducted in the State. » **Page 3**

Jobseekers stage stir outside U.P. Dy. CM's house

LUCKNOW
Hundreds of candidates seeking recruitment to 3,284 Junior Assistant posts staged a protest outside the residence of U.P. Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak on Wednesday demanding completion of the recruitment process. » **Page 4**

SC orders oversight of Bar Council’s policy decisions

Manan Kumar Mishra is only pro tem chief of the lawyers’ body, says the top court; it directs the council to consult Attorney-General, Solicitor-General for all major decisions until fresh elections

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday made it clear that senior advocate Manan Kumar Mishra is serving only as the “pro tem” chairperson of the Bar Council of India (BCI) until fresh elections are held and directed the apex lawyers’ body to consult the Attorney-General and the Solicitor-General before taking any major policy decisions in the interim.

The hearing before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant saw petitioners, including young lawyers, raise allegations, including the formation of the BCI Pearl First Trust in 2020 in which Mr. Mishra, also a BJP Rajya Sabha member,

Under scrutiny

The BCI chief, Manan Kumar Mishra, recently earned public ire with an attempt to ban the enrolment of NALSAR graduates

Allegations raised by petitioners in SC:

- Extension of the tenure of the BCI chairperson and vice-chairperson to five years
- Formation of the BCI Pearl First Trust in which Mr. Mishra and other BCI office-bearers are ‘permanent managing trustees’
- A tie-up between the Trust and the Goa government to set up a university on 56 acres of land in the State
- ‘Jolting’ expenditures on felicitations ‘running into crores’



and other BCI office-bearers are “permanent managing trustees”; a tie-up between the Trust and the Goa government to set up a university on 56 acres of land in the State; “jolting” expenditures on felicitations “running into crores”; and an extension

of the tenure of BCI chairperson/vice-chairperson to five years. Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench, said the top court did not want to encourage “shadow-boxing” around these allegations, but would certainly intervene to “maintain the

institutional integrity and credibility” of the BCI till the next bar body elections. Meanwhile, Mr. Mishra and the current office-bearers would continue pro tem to ensure the BCI’s day-to-day functioning. “You are a pro tem chairperson. Your term is co-terminus with the elections. The Attorney-General and the Solicitor-General, as permanent ex-officio members of the BCI, would be given prior notice by you and invited to participate in any decision-making process having a policy impact... After all, the Attorney-General is as much a member of the BCI as the chairperson is,” Justice Bagchi observed.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

UN charts course to manage global warming-limit breach

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

Warning that a possible breach of the 1.5 degrees Celsius global warming limit will bring irreversible ecological losses that no adaptation initiatives could undo, the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) on Wednesday, for the first time, set out a detailed “overshoot, peak, and decline” pathway. The pathway projects a trajectory where the world overshoots the 2015 Paris Agreement’s central goal of limiting the rise in average global temperatures to 1.5 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels – which a UNEP report said was now unavoidable. The pathway seeks to hold peak temperatures after the overshoot as low as possible and then bring it back down below the limit by 2100.

The report, *Limiting Overshoot*, said global warming would cross 1.5 degrees Celsius “in the

Climate concerns

The UN report proposes a pathway to hold peak global temperature as low as possible in the coming years and bring it back within the accepted limit by 2100

- The report says global warming will cross **1.5°C** ‘in the next few years’ and that this is **no longer avoidable**
- A scenario in which every country delivers on its national climate plan and its net-zero target still puts peak global warming at **1.8°C**
- Current policies point to about **2.6°C** global warming by 2100, with a range of 1.9–3.6°C
- ‘Overshoot, peak, and decline’ is simply **‘the best remaining option’**, the report says



next few years”. Even a scenario in which every country delivers on its national climate plan and net-zero target puts peak warming at 1.8 degrees Celsius, it said. According to the report, current policies point to a rise of about 2.6 degrees Celsius by 2100.

“Overshoot, peak, and decline”, the report said, “is by no means an acceptable or preferred path-

way; it is simply the best remaining option”. “This summer’s scorching heat, raging wildfires, and deadly floods are a warning of what lies ahead. We must make the overshoot as small and short as possible,” UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres said in a statement.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

Iran targets Gulf nations after U.S. strikes

Associated Press
DUBAI

Iran fired on U.S. allies in the Gulf early on Wednesday following a night of American bombardment

that Iranian officials say included a deadly strike on a wedding party. Fighting in the region has escalated since the U.S. hit Iranian assets on an island in the Strait of Hor-

muz over the weekend. Iran retaliated by firing missiles at American bases in Jordan that were intercepted. Kuwait and Bahrain said they had also come under attack.

Iran has said four members of its paramilitary Revolutionary Guard died in the U.S. attacks.

FULL REPORT ON
» **PAGE 14**

Allahabad HC quashes DU law student’s NSA detention

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday quashed the detention of a 25-year-old Delhi University (DU) law student under the National Security Act (NSA). Akriti Chaudhary was among several activists arrested in cases related to the workers’ protest in Noida between April 10 and 18. During the strike, industrial and contractual workers demanded salary hikes and parity with wages paid in neighbouring Haryana. On April 13, the protest had turned violent and roads were blocked. Ms. Chaudhary has spent nearly five months in custody in connection with the protest.

‘Concocted story’

A Bench of Justice Atul Sreedharan and Justice Achal Sachdev allowed Ms. Chaudhary’s habeas corpus plea and ordered her immediate release, unless she was required in another case. The court also flagged discrepancies in the arrest notice and called the State’s version a “concocted story”.

DETAILS ON
» **PAGE 10**
» **‘FIGHT WILL GO ON’**
» **PAGE 4**



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SPOTLIGHT

Braving the odds

A decade after the enactment of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, parents of children with disabilities continue to face hardships.
A.S. Jayanth meets some parents in Kerala to document their struggles

A dilemma rattled Rani Mahesh*, a native of Koyilandy in Kerala's Kozhikode, when her husband was admitted to a private medical college hospital in the district for treatment a few years ago. She wanted to be with him. But her only child, who has cerebral palsy, could not be left alone at home.

"Worried about who would look after her, I couldn't stop crying on the bus while going back home from the hospital that day. As suggested by a friend, I decided to take my child to a privately run care home for differently abled children in my home town. But I was not familiar with the place then," she says.

Help came in the form of P.K. Jameela* from Malappuram, who volunteered to take care of the child there.

"She understood my anxiety because her child too was differently abled. She attended to my daughter's needs along with her own child for over 40 days," says Rani. She is among the many parents in Kerala whose lives are inseparably linked with that of their children. But their concerns rarely get the attention they deserve, according to them. K.N. Roshan Bijlee, director, Composite Regional Centre for Skill Development, Rehabilitation and Empowerment of Persons With Disabilities (CRC), a network of nodal institutions set up by the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, Ministry of Social Justice in Kozhikode, points out that every such parent goes through different stages of grief.

"There is denial of reality; anger or frustration either at oneself or others; an attempt to get out of the situation; a period of sadness or depression; and finally the acceptance of reality," he says. Roshan claims that there have also been episodes of men deserting their wives after blaming them for the child's condition.

Worried about future

As the child grows up, the nature of the challenges also changes. "The child can somehow clear Class 12 with the help of a scribe. But most parents will then be worried about their future as adults. In the past year alone, there have been over 20 cases of such parents either trying to kill their adult children or attempting to end their lives in Kerala. 'What will happen to my child after my life' is their biggest concern," he says.

Around 34% of the parents of girls are worried about the safety and well-being of their children in their absence. Menstrual hygiene management is another challenge, leading to increased



There are many government projects and schemes for the differently abled. We need to ensure that they are reaching the intended beneficiaries

T.K. MUHAMMED YUNUS
General secretary of a private care home



Children with disabilities and their parents need a lifetime of support. K. RAGESH

physical and mental fatigue. Sleeplessness is common.

There are also instances of social stigma as attempts are made to keep differently abled children away from events such as weddings. Such attitudes affect the parents, Roshan says. D.K. Babu, a retired college teacher in Kozhikode, whose son is differently abled, agrees with this.

"It has been only a decade since Parliament passed the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act to protect the dignity, rights, and inclusion of differently abled individuals. Society needs to accept the fact that most of them cannot survive without their parents' help," he notes.

Babu is part of an association of parents for the rehabilitation and assistance for differently abled individuals. Social activists say that the parents, especially mothers, are often forced to give up their higher studies, careers, and social lives altogether.

A recent survey conducted by a private care home centre among a select group of 200 parents shows that there are at least four PhD holders, one of them from an Indian Institute of Technology, and 30 postgraduate degree holders, who are unable to pursue a career for themselves. Most of them were avoiding social events too.

U. Nandakumar, former Professor of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation, Sree Chitra Tirunal Institute for Medical Sciences and Technology, Thiruvananthapuram, meanwhile, says there still exists a conservative section in Kerala that blames mothers for their children's condition.

who offer magical cures. They even sell their properties falsely believing that their child will get better. However, such treatment will only hurt the children," he says.

T.K. Muhammed Yunus, general secretary of a private care home in Kozhikode and convener of the local-level committee of National Trust of India, a statutory body chaired by the District Collector, feels the need to financially empower parents, who also need mental health support.

"There are many government projects and schemes for the differently abled. We need to ensure that they are reaching the intended beneficiaries. We have enough institutions and laws, but they need to be made more effective. Launching new projects is not the solution; empowering the existing ones is. For example, there is a provision for pension for differently abled people. But how many are getting it and how many are left out—such things need to be streamlined," he says.

Need for follow-up

Most often, projects are launched and schemes are announced, but there is no proper follow-up or evaluation, he feels. Yunus suggests a convergence between the Departments of Education, Health, and Social Justice to solve the concerns. "A start can be made by including their real-life problems in the school curriculum, which otherwise gives information only about success stories," he says.

Recently, a collective of parents for the rehabilitation and assistance for differently abled individuals had launched a community living space at Keezhariyur in Kozhikode to help their children stand on their own feet.

The parents pooled in money to buy land. They are planning to construct 25 houses of 800 sq. ft. each on the campus. The work on five houses is over. Vocational training centres, therapy units, classrooms, dormitories, common kitchen, recreational parks, turf ground, and a health centre too are in the pipeline. The idea is to have a space where people with intellectual disabilities can live even in the absence of their parents, according to those at the collective.

"The children can stay with their parents in their houses and also in the dormitories. This is to give them an experience of self-reliance," K. Koyatty, the trust chairperson, says.

Roshan highlights the need for a lifetime of support for parents at varying stages of the growth of their children.

"Unfortunately, many parents remain unaware of the different milestones of brain development, identification of issues, and proper intervention, especially for neurological disorders. At least some of them don't know what medical methods are available to detect the various types of disability and the therapies available," he says.

A Social Justice Department official, who preferred not to be named, claims that the existing policy itself is "parent-centric".

Government initiatives

Besides private institutions, there are a few government initiatives in northern Kerala, including the Regional Intervention Centre and Autism Centre attached to the Government Medical College Hospital, Kozhikode, and the District Early Intervention Centre at the Government General Hospital, Kozhikode. At the regional level, there are community-based disability management centres attached to primary health centres. However, he admits that other districts may not have many such facilities.

The organisations of parents of children with intellectual and developmental disabilities are also actively working in the sector. Roshan says that many outreach programmes are being held under the CRC to connect with the parents. "We have one section for those aged up to six and another for those aged above six. There are departments for physiotherapy, occupational therapy, clinical psychology, physical medicine, speech and hearing, audiology, and special education. There is a comprehensive system," he adds.

A.K. Abdul Hakeem, a former Samagra Shiksha Kerala (SSK) official involved in the design of projects for differently abled students, suggests setting up a social security system in the public sector to address the parents' concerns.

"The problem is more severe for those aged above 18. We need to have schemes to convert their physical or intellectual disability as an advantage. For example, people with intellectual disabilities could be deployed for jobs that are mechanical in nature after they are properly trained," he says.

Addressing the demand from social activists to set up respite care centres in districts for providing temporary accommodation to differently abled people so that the caregivers can attend to emergencies, medical treatment, travel, or social events, the Social Justice department earlier in August declared the launch of three 'Anpu' homes in the State.

The differently abled people and their parents can stay for up to seven days there. One beneficiary can make use of the facility twice in six months. At a time, 25 to 30 people will be admitted.

"Each scheme or project gives hope for these people. The government should first ensure that the end-result is positive," Yunus suggests. Rani found a pillar of support in Jameela. But most people are not that lucky. "I can only wish I will get similar help when I need it," Jameela sighs. (Names changed to protect privacy.)

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LEGAL NOTICE

BEFORE THE HON'BLE DISTRICT CONSUMER DISPUTES REDRESSAL COMMISSION, TIRUNELVELI
CC.No: 173 of 2025

A.Anitha Mary,
w/o Dr. Ajith Inigo, ...Petitioner

-Vs-

1. The Manager, Amazon Office, World Trade Centre, 1st Cross Road, Milk Colony, Subramanyanagar, 2 State, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka-560055.
2. The Proprietor Nilesht Ratana Muzat, GEBI Enterprises, Shop no. 11, nilgiri garden, sector-24 chd belapur NAVI MUMBAI, MAHARASHTRA, 400614.

...Respondents

Notice

Despite multiple summons being issued, the 2nd Respondent in the aforementioned case has failed to appear before the Court. The 2nd Respondent may appear either in person or through counsel before this Court on 08.10.2026 at 10:30 AM to raise any objections. Please be advised that, failing this, an ex parte order may be passed against the 2nd Respondent.

By Order of the court /
J.Jebasingh Selwyn B.Tech., LL.M,
S.Thanga Srijia B.A.,B.L
Advocates, Tirunelveli.

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COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Hunney Mittal Judicial Magistrate - 1st Class Gurugram

MADAN MOHAN SHARMA VS. JAYSHREE JHA

Detail of offence:-

CNR No.-: HRGR03-021636-2024

NACT/9742/2024

Next Date:-16-09-2026

DATE OF APPEARANCE:-03-11-2026

NOTICE TO:

JAYSHREE JHA :- R/O FLAT NO 42 - A-401, 4TH FLOOR, KANCHANGANGA

APNA GHAR UNIT NO 12 CHS LTD, 1ST CROSS LANE, LOKHANDWALA, A N D H E R I W E S T M U M B A I

MAHARASHTRA 400053

In above titled case, the accused could not be served. It is ordered that accused should appear in person or through counsel on 03-11-2026 at 10.00 a.m.

For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?trs=district_notice&district=Gurugram

Judicial Magistrate - 1st Class Gurugram

Dated, this day of 01-09-2026

COURT NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Hunney Mittal Judicial Magistrate - 1st Class Gurugram

MADAN MOHAN SHARMA VS. JAYSHREE JHA

Detail of offence:-

CNR No.-: HRGR03-103794-2024

NACT/36887/2024

Next Date:-16-09-2026

DATE OF APPEARANCE:-03-11-2026

NOTICE TO:

JAYSHREE JHA :- R/O FLAT NO 42 - A-401, 4TH FLOOR, KANCHANGANGA

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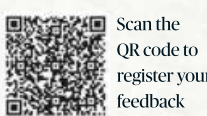
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Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount Put to Tender
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Office of the Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT), 9th floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K G Road, Bangalore -09

IFT No. BWSSB/CE(D&QA)/ACE(D)/TA/1305/2026-27 Date: 01.09.2026

1.	Work of Construction of Service Station Building at Nellurahalli Lake & Hoodi GLR coming under EE(E-1) Division, Bengaluru.	Rs.1,82,11,995.31 Rs.2,73,200/-
2.	Work of Construction of Sub Division office at Bellandur for AEE(E-1-3), Bengaluru.	Rs.1,90,14,285/- Rs.2,85,300/- Rs.1,62,79,622/- Rs.2,44,194/-
3.	Work of Construction of Division office at R.T. Nagar, Bengaluru.	

For all the above works last date & time for receipt of tenders: 16.09.2026 upto 16.00 hrs. Technical bids will be opened on 17.09.2026 at 16.00 hrs.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT)

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours

Government of Odisha
Office of Special Relief Commissioner
NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

No. 4797 / R&DM(DM), Dt. 02.09.2026

The Office of the Special Relief Commissioner, Government of Odisha, invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from reputed, technically competent and experienced Agencies/ Firms/ System Integrators having proven experience in Early Warning Dissemination Systems, Public Warning Systems, Emergency Communication Systems, Mass Notification Systems and Disaster Management Communication Technologies for Selection Agency for Establishment, Upgradation, Integration, Operation and Maintenance of Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS) in the State.

- Detailed document with terms & conditions of EOI can be downloaded from <https://srcodisha.nic.in>
- Last date for submission of EOI : 25th September, 2026 by 15:00 Hrs
- Mode of Submission of EOI : Online via email : srcodishagov@gmail.com/ Sealed hardcopy to the following address in Registered Post.

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80/2026	Power-Driven Chaff cutters	3000
81/2026	Genset for Walk-in-Coolers	60
82/2026	Livestock Insurance Services for animals under Free Milch Cow Distribution Scheme and Vetri Magalir Goat Rearing Scheme.	1,60,000 Animals

Individual tender documents with full details can be downloaded at free of cost from <https://tntenders.gov.in> upto 05.10.2026, 11.00 am

Last date for submission of tenders: 05.10.2026, 11.00 am
Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above website.

DIPR/2751/TENDER/2026
Chief Executive Officer

Bihar Cabinet
okays ₹9,169
crore funds
for ULBs

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

The Bihar Cabinet on Wednesday gave its nod for allocation of ₹9,169 crore for all the Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) of the State for a period of five years in view of 16th Finance Commission. The ULBs will receive the amount as a basic grant and performance grant for the financial years 2026-27 to 2030-31.

Talking to reporters, Urban Development and Housing Department Minister Nitish Mishra said about 90% of the funds are allocated based on population criteria while 10% will now be allocated on a performance-based criterion.

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☀️	RISE 06:24	SET 18:52
🌙	RISE 23:11	SET 11:58
FRIDAY, SEP. 04		
☀️	RISE 06:24	SET 18:51
🌙	RISE 00:00	SET 13:02
SATURDAY, SEP. 05		
☀️	RISE 06:24	SET 18:50
🌙	RISE 00:08	SET 14:06

Mumbai Weather	max	min
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Mumbai Today
32°C The weather will be little warm. Spell of light rain and thundershower to occur. Night will be comfortable.

Mumbai Tomorrow
32°C The weather to remain little warm. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

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Jharkhand BJP demands CBI
probe into ‘scam’ in exams

Party issues 48-hour ultimatum, warns of protests alongside students if demands not met; citing SC directive, it asks for withdrawal of cases against students in connection with recent agitation

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

A Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) delegation on Wednesday met Chief Secretary Avinash Kumar at Project Bhavan in Ranchi and submitted a memorandum demanding a CBI inquiry into alleged irregularities in several examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC).

The delegation, led by Jharkhand BJP president Aditya Sahu and Leader of the Opposition Babulal Marandi, also demanded the immediate withdrawal of cases filed against students across the State in connection with protests over the alleged irregularities. The BJP issued a 48-hour ultimatum to the State government, warning it would launch protests alongside students if the cases are not withdrawn.



Jharkhand Leader of Opposition Babulal Marandi. FILE PHOTO

matum to the State government, warning it would launch protests alongside students if the cases are not withdrawn.

‘Denied justice’ Addressing the media after the meeting, Mr. Sahu said the BJP would “hit the streets” in support of students if justice is not delivered within 48 hours. He

told the Chief Secretary that students worked hard for years to prepare for these examinations, but were denied justice because of alleged irregularities within the JPSC and the JSSC, where jobs were “sold” and question papers leaked.

Mr. Sahu also alleged that on the instructions of Chief Minister Hemant Soren, police resorted to baton charges when students were protesting peacefully and constitutionally against the exam “irregularities”. He further alleged that Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) workers acted as “goons” and attacked the students, while FIRs were registered against more than 1,000 students in an attempt to suppress their voices.

“JMM workers engaged in hooliganism against stu-

dents in the districts of Ranchi, Giridih, Chatra, Hazaribagh, and Ramgarh, brandishing lathis and party flags. In Ramgarh, a JMM leader threatened to thrash students. Such terror is unprecedented,” Mr. Sahu said. He said no case has been registered against the JMM leaders who allegedly attacked students.

Citing the Supreme Court’s directive on withdrawal of cases against students involved in protests, the letter urged the CS to withdraw all cases registered against Jharkhand students during their “peaceful agitation”.

The delegation included BJP national secretary Pradeep Verma, former State president Deepak Prakash, State general secretary Amar Kumar Bauri, MP B.D. Ram, and MLA Naveen Jaiswal.

MP seeks action report
on encroachments on
drains in Gurugram

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Union Minister of State and Gurugram MP Rao Inderjit Singh on Wednesday expressed regret to residents affected by the recent waterlogging and said a permanent solution would require restoring the city’s natural drainage system, maximising rainwater harvesting and recharging groundwater.

At a meeting with senior officials of the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority, Municipal Corporation of Gurugram and district administration, Mr. Singh sought an action-taken report on notices issued by Irrigation Department officials to builders over encroachments on natural drains. He also sought an inquiry report into alleged corruption to suppress the notices, warning that he would seek a CBI probe if

necessary.

He directed Urban Development Adviser and former Chief Secretary D.S. Dhesi to coordinate among the civic bodies and departments to formulate a comprehensive, long-term policy on waterlogging. He also sought a detailed report on encroachments on nearly half a dozen ponds and natural drains.

Mr. Singh said natural drainage routes had been affected by development and construction, particularly by licences issued between 2004 and 2012. Construction material and construction and demolition waste dumped into drains had further reduced their capacity, he said.

Mr. Singh warned that encroachments on natural drains must be removed. If officials failed to act, he said, he would take up the matter with the Chief Minister and, if necessary, approach the court.

Odisha stares
at floods again
as rain batters
adjoining State

The Hindu Bureau
BHUBANESWAR

The Odisha government on Wednesday warned of another round of flooding in Balasore district as the Subarnarekha river, swollen by heavy rain in neighbouring Jharkhand, was in spate.

Due to heavy rain in Jharkhand, floodwater was entering the Subarnarekha river through 13 gates which were opened at Gauludih barrage.

As against danger level of 10.36 metres in Subarnarekha at Rajghat in Jaleswar, water was flowing above 11.63 metres.

As per Water Resource Department, the water level in Subarnarekha could rise above 11.80 metres by night.

Floodwater has already entered 65 villages in Bhogarai block of Balasore, 60 of Baliapala and 12 villages of Jaleswar block.

IDFC First Bank ‘scam’: chargesheet filed
against 6 Haryana IAS officers, 13 others

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Wednesday filed a chargesheet against 19 accused, including six IAS officers of Haryana cadre, three officials of IDFC First Bank and one of AU Small Finance Bank, in the alleged misappropriation of ₹504 crore funds of various departments and organisations of the State government, officials said.

The agency has named IAS officers – Mohd. Shayin, Saket Kumar, Pardeep Kumar, Vineet Garg, Ram Kumar Singh and Pankaj Agarwal – in its third chargesheet filed before a special court in Panchkula in the case, the officials said.

In its chargesheet, the CBI has also named IDFC First Bank officials Shamim Ahmed Dar, Sudha Goyal, Kuldeep Singh, and AU Small Finance Bank’s Charanjeet Singh Randhawa. It

has also named other Haryana government officials as accused including Deepti Kaushik, Rajesh Goyal, Prince Sharma, Saurav Kumar, Parveen Kumar, Surender Jain, Surinder Kaur, Amit Kumar and Jugal Kishor.

The CBI has invoked charges of criminal conspiracy, cheating, destruction of evidence, forgery, using false documents, agency spokesperson Beena Yadav said.

SP-Cong. alliance will form govt. in U.P.: Shivpal

Press Trust of India
ETAH

Samajwadi Party (SP) national general secretary Shivpal Singh Yadav on Wednesday said the SP-Congress alliance would contest the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly election together and form a full-majority government under the leadership of Akhilesh Yadav.

Speaking to reporters here, Mr. Shivpal said the alliance with Congress

would remain intact for the Assembly poll and expressed confidence that the SP would return to power in the State with a clear majority.

He said the party had not yet disclosed its election strategy and would reveal it at an appropriate time.

Targeting the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), he alleged that the ruling party was attempting to weaken the Opposition. Referring to the FIR lodged against

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi in Uttarakhand, he said the BJP wanted to eliminate the Opposition.

On BJP’s alleged use of AI-generated videos targeting SP leaders, Mr. Shivpal said the BJP had started the practice and the SP had merely “reacted to the action”.

He also attacked the BJP over alleged corruption, saying the condition of roads and potholes on expressways had exposed its claims of development.

Mr. Shivpal also hit out at Om Prakash Rajbhar over his recent remarks, saying his statements against the BJP while he was aligned with the SP were “all on record”.

Mr. Shivpal was in Etah to meet former SP MLA Rameshwar Singh Yadav, who is recovering after a lung transplant, and to offer condolences to the family of SP leader Sharafat Hussain alias Kale on the death of his father Haji Abdul Aziz.

THE HINDU

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U.T ADMINISTRATION OF DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU	
Public Works Department - Daman	
NOTICE INVITING TENDER	
Regarding Repairing and servicing of lifts including spare parts at various government offices / Buildings for the Period of 02 years. (E-47625)	
Tender ID No.: 2026_DAMAN_4944_1	
Pre bid meeting date	: --
Last date of download	: 08/09/2026
Last date of hard copy submission	: 08/09/2026
Bid opening date	: 08/09/2026
Executive Engineer, P.W.D., W.D.-I, Moti Daman.	
NO: IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/470 dated 02/09/2026	

WESTERN RAILWAY

Repairing and Replacement of Defective Parts

Sr. DEE (P) BCT, Western Railway, Mumbai Central invites Tender No. EL-Maint-4-343-WA-8 Dt. 28.08.2026. Name of the work: Mumbai Division Suburban Section - Repairing / replacement of defective parts of Window AC & Split AC units of various makes & capacities at various locations between Marine Lines to Virar for 2 years. Approx cost of work: Rs.1,37,95,190/- EMD: Rs.2,75,900/- Date and time of submission of tender: Till 06.10.2026, 15:00 hrs. Date and time of opening of tender: On 06.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs. For further details, please visit our website www.irops.gov.in 0539

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Follow us on @SCRailwayIndia Details of the Tender Notices of S.C Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

TENDER NOTICE

On behalf of the president of India, Sr. Division Signal & Telecom Engineer, Hyderabad Division, South Central Railway, Secunderabad invites open tenders for the following works through e-Procurement up to 11.30 Hours of 23.09.2026

Sl. No.: 1, Tender No. Y/SG/36/2026-27/17 Tender Dated 31.08.2026, Name of the work: Hyderabad Division: Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract for WESTRACE-MKII based disturbed Electronic Interlocking (EI) System of make M/s. SIEMENS Rail Automation Pvt. Ltd., Provided at Nizamabad Station in Hyderabad Division for a period of one year., Tender Value (Rs.): 17,19,901.00, EMD (Rs.): 34,400.00

For bid document and other details log in to https://irops.gov.in. Any corrigendum issued online only.

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Hyderabad

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at http://www.irops.gov.in or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: CAO/CN/BNC/EPC/195/2026 Dated 24.08.2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders for the following works:

Item of work	Approx. Value
Request for Proposal (Rs. 152,27,24,994/- for Engineering, Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode for Construction of Major Bridges (34 Nos) between Hosapete (Excl.) and Ballari (Excl.) Stations, as part of Ballari - Hosapete 3rd & 4th line project. (Tender Ref. No.: SPT-BAY-MAJOR BRIDGES-EPC)	
Last date for submission of bids: Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 25.11.2026	
For details log on: www.irops.gov.in	
Deputy Chief Engineer/Construction/ Works/Bengaluru Cantt.	
PUB/418/AAMO/PRB/SWR/2026-27	
Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.	
[S] South Western Railway - SWR [S] SWR/RT [S] SWARAJ/RAJ [S] sw_railways	

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: CAO/CN/BNC/196/2026 Dated 25.08.2026

The undersigned, on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders for the following works:

Sl.No	Item of work	Approx. Value
1	Construction of ROB at Km. 137/259 in Lieu of LC No. 81 (Manned traffic) 1x30.0m Composite girder (Railway Span) and 12x18.71 PSC Girder (Approach Portion) and Limited height subway 1x5.0x2.5m RCC box between Tipplur - Banashankari Stations (Composite Work). (Tender Ref. No. ROB-LC-81-TR-BNK)	Rs. 27,93,60,565/-
2	(1) Proposed conversion of halt into crossing station with two loop lines at Nandi (NDY) - PH-16. (2) Provision of 3 Additional Stabling Lines at Sri Shasthi Prasanthi Nilayam (SSPN) - PH-16. (3) Proposed New Goods Line Arrangements at Yelluru Station (Y) - PH-16. (4) Penultimate (PKD) - Diarmavaram (DDM) Section: Proposed Additional loop line at Narayanapuram Yard (NRYPP) - PH-16 - (Composite Work). (Tender Ref. No. ADDL-LINE-NDY-SSPN-NRYPP)	Rs. 82,21,19,802/-
Last date for submission of bids: Upto 15:00 Hrs. on 18.09.2026		
For details log on: www.irops.gov.in		
Deputy Chief Engineer/Construction/ Works/Bengaluru Cantt.		
PUB/418/AAMO/PRB/SWR/2026-27		
Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.		
[S] South Western Railway - SWR [S] SWR/RT [S] SWARAJ/RAJ [S] sw_railways		

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/EIA/ETND-EC-04/1423/2026-27 Dated: 01.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER TO
PROVIDE CONSULTANCY SERVICES FOR
OBTAINING ENVIRONMENTAL CLEARANCE (EC)
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB is inviting tender under two cover systems for providing Consultancy Services from Environmental Consultant of NABET under 7(c) category with NABL Accredited Consultant/MOU with NABET & NABL Accredited Consultancy Services Accredited Consultant are eligible to participate in this tenders.

Name of the Works: (1) Providing Consultancy Services for preparing EIA, SIS studies etc., to obtain Environmental Clearance (EC) from State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA) Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) and Consent for Establishment (CFE) from Karnataka State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) and submission of Half-yearly compliance Report for all the conditions of EC & CFE for 3 years for Kochanahalli 2nd Phase Industrial Area, Mysuru taluk & District in an Extent 403.25 acres. EMD: Rs. 2.00 Lakhs. (2) Providing Consultancy Services for preparing EIA, SIS studies etc., to obtain Environmental Clearance (EC) from State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA) Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) and Consent for Establishment (CFE) from Karnataka State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB) and submission of Half-yearly compliance Report for all the conditions of EC & CFE for 3 years for Masthenahalli 3rd Phase Industrial Area, Chintamani taluk, Chikkaballapura District in an Extent 614.98 acres. EMD: Rs. 2.00 Lakhs.

Scheduled of dates are as follows :

1. Last date to receive pre bid Queries: 09.09.2026 up to 4:00 pm
2. Pre bid meeting will be held on: 09.09.2026 at 4.30 pm
3. Last date for submission of bids is: 17.09.2026 upto 04:00 pm
4. Time and date of opening Technical bids is on: 18.09.2026 at 04:30 pm

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal https://kpppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2535/SMCL/2026-27

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-34/1422/2026-27 Date: 01.09.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

Name of the Works: Formation of Balance Industrial Layout including formation of 30m, 18m & 15m wide roads including Asphalting, Construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Cross drainage works at Masthenahalli Industrial Area, 2nd Phase, Chinthamani Taluk, Chikkaballapura District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : 17.09.2026 upto 4.00 pm.

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal https://kpppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/2534/SMCL/2026-27

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION OF GREATER MUMBAI

PUBLIC HEALTH DEPARTMENT
DR.V.N.SHIRODKAR MCGM MATERNITY HOME, VILE PARLE (EAST)
Expression of Interest

Sub:- In K/South ward at Dr.V.N.Shirodkar MCGM Maternity Home, Vile Parle (E) “D” class employee which is to be filled on purely contract basis 06 months from NGO.

In K/South ward under Public Health Department Dr.V.N.Shirodkar MCGM Maternity Home, Vile Parle (E) “D” class 10 employees which are to be filled on purely contract basis 06 months from NGO (Excluding Saving Bachat Gat) under register of Employee Provident Fund and Employee Insurance as Kamgar Sahakari Santha, Seva Sahakari Santha, Berojgar Seva Sahakari Santha, Audyogik Seva Sahakari Santha, Non Government Organisation (Their intention to give employment). Application are invited with all required papers for list prepared for Lottery process.

Application form available at Dr.V.N.Shirodkar MCGM Maternity Home, Paranjape B Scheme, Hanuman Road, Vile Parle (E) in office from 04.09.2026 to 15.09.2026 morning 11.00 to afternoon 04.00 (Excluding Weekly and Public Holidays). For more information as Form, Challan and other documents details available at Dr.V.N.Shirodkar MCGM Maternity Home, Vile Parle (E). Application form with all concern documents with proper seal submitted from 04.09.2026 to 15.09.2026 till 04.00 p.m. Last date of application submitted on 15.09.2026 afternoon 04.00 pm after that applications not accepted.

Sd/-
Medical Officer Incharge
Dr. V.N.Shirodkar MCGM Maternity Home
Vile Parle (E)

PRO/ 1292/ADV/2026-27
AVOID SELF MEDICATION

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY

VISAKHAPATNAM
Follow us on @SCRailway
Website: www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

Tender Notice No. VSKP-TRS-RT-11-2026-27

Sr.DEE/TRS/VSKP acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No VSKP-TRS-RT-11-2026-27. Closing Date/Time: 21/09/2026 15:00 Hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.:

Name of work with its location: Fitment of Trap Chamber in Three Phase Locomotives (WAP-7 & WAG-9) for collection Coal/Dust particles from BP Train Pipe during emergency brake application. Value of Tender (₹): 11,14,606.55, Earnest Money to be deposited (₹): 22,300.00, Cost of Tender Form (₹): 2,360.00, Completion period of the work: One Year (12 Months), Bidding system: Single packet system (e-tendering), Tender closing date and time: 21.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs, Website particulars: https://www.irops.gov.in, Address of the Office: Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS), Electric Loco Shed, South Coast Railway, NAD Post, Visakhapatnam - 530009.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ SCoR-A283 TRS/Visakhapatnam

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at http://www.irops.gov.in or www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

U.T ADMINISTRATION OF DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU

Government College, Daman	
ADVERTISEMENT	
Advertisement for the post of Assistant Professor in English on Short Term Contract. Advertisement No. GC/DMN/PG/ Application STC/2026-27/693 Dated: 31/08/2026.	
Last date for receipt of Application at the College Office: 15/09/2026, 05:00 PM	
Advertisement & Application form can be downloaded from www.ddd.gov.in.	
Principal, Government College, Daman	
NO: IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/469 dated 02/09/2026	

APPOINTMENT

कोचीन शिपयार्ड लिमिटेड
भारत सरकार की सेवा में, 1. मिनिस्टर ऑफ़, पोर्ट, पोर्ट डेवलपमेंट और जलमार्ग संवर्धन
COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED
A Government of India Category-I, Miniratna Company, Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways

No. CSL/P&A/RECT/CANSRU CONT/NOTIFICATION 11/SP0&P/2026/2 Date: 14.08.2026

CSL AN SHIP REPAIR UNIT(CANSRU), SRI VIJAYA PURAM

REQUIRES SENIOR PROJECT OFFICER/ PROJECT OFFICER ON CONTRACT BASIS

Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), a listed premier Mini Ratna Schedule 'A' Company of Govt of India, invites Online application for Senior Project Officer/ Project Officer on Contract Basis for CSL AN Ship Repair Unit (CANSRU), Sri Vijaya Puram.

Sl. No.	Name of Posts	No. of Vacancies
1	Senior Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)
2	Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)

For more details on Age, Reservation, Educational Qualification, Experience, Remuneration etc., please read the vacancy notification on CSL website www.cochinshipyard.in (Career page—CANSRU (ANDAMAN)). Last date of receipt of online application is 14.09.2026.

“Hindi version of detailed advertisement is published on the website (www.cochinshipyard.in) of CSL.”
Sd/-
GENERAL MANAGER (HR&LD)

INBRIEF



Bengal CM drives road roller over cough syrup bottles

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Wednesday drove a road roller over two lakh bottles of codeine-based cough syrup in Balurghat, saying the State is committed to fight against drugs abuse. He was accompanied by Balurghat MP Sukanta Majumdar, Health Minister Sharadwat Mukherjee at the event in Dakshin Dinajpur district. The banned cough syrup bottles were lined up outside the Superintendent of Police's office. The CM drove the roller over the bottles as a message against drug abuse and drug peddling in the State and a warning to smugglers.

LJP (RV) demands enhanced security for Chirag after threat

The Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) [LJP (RV)] on Wednesday sought enhanced security for party president Chirag Paswan after he allegedly received a death threat. A delegation of LJP(RV) leaders met Bihar DGP Vinay Kumar and raised concerns over the threat messages, which, according to Mr. Paswan's office, claimed that he would be "killed by terrorists". The Union Minister, a Z-category protectee, received the messages on Tuesday, his office said. "I, along with other party legislators met the DGP. We conveyed our concern over the threat. The DGP assured us the matter is being investigated," party's State chief Surender Vivek said.

Relieved by HC order but my fight will go on till all workers come out: Akriti

Hope Satyam is also freed of all charges, says DU student about fellow prison inmate who was also booked under NSA; knew she had done nothing wrong, says father, calls her 'today's Bhagat Singh'

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Akriti Chaudhary, the 25-year-old Delhi University student, expressed relief over the Allahabad High Court order quashing the National Security Act (NSA) against her. However, her struggle will continue until the release of all those jailed following the workers' protest in April this year, she added.

"The NSA charge being quashed is a great relief but the fight will not end until the release of all workers and activists," she told *The Hindu* at the prison in Greater Noida.

Ms. Chaudhary then turned to Satyam Verma, the other individual against whom the police had invoked the stringent law on May 13, and said, "Hopefully he is also freed of all the charges."

Tears were clearly visible on her face behind an iron mesh barrier, where



The 25-yr.-old student said she has kept herself busy in prison by teaching children of fellow women inmates. FILE PHOTO

she stood with other activists waiting to meet friends and family.

'Proud of daughter'

Her father, Arun Chaudhary, said, "My daughter is the Bhagat Singh of today. She always had full support from us. We never felt she had done anything wrong. I have full faith in the justice system."

"A cheerful and sensitive person such as Akriti can never pose any kind of

threat to national security. But she was declared a threat to the nation just for trying to create a better society. Even the NSA could not break her courage," said Naureen, a history graduate and friend.

Ms. Chaudhary hails from Durgapur in West Bengal and is in her first year of LLB at DU's Law Faculty.

Life in jail

Speaking about her experience in prison, Ms. Chaudhary said she took the initiative to cook and clean, and also taught the children of women inmates. Along with Manisha Chauhan and Srishti, who were also taken into custody by the Uttar Pradesh police in protest-related cases, she says she restarted a defunct library and encouraged others to read.

"We have been working because there is nothing wrong with maintaining and taking care of the place we live in," said the

DU student. The three also attended various vocational classes in the prison, including tailoring and cosmetics, she said.

"Our schedule involves regular work. Besides that, we teach children. We have made posters, written poems, decorated our library and common rooms, and started a culture of reading and discussion. It worked as a distraction for women arrested for participating in the protest and helped ease the sadness that followed as they were separated from their families," she said.

Ms. Chaudhary is also a theatre practitioner and is associated with the Disha Students' Organisation. She studied history at DU's Daulat Ram College.

She was one of the four persons arrested by police from Botanical Garden metro station on April 11, two days before the violence.

CONCORTED STORY: HC
» PAGE 10

T.N. govt. to withdraw cases against farmers and teachers filed during DMK regime

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday announced the withdrawal of cases filed against protesting farmers and teachers between 2021 and 2026 during the previous DMK regime.

Making a *suo motu* statement in the Assembly, he said the government would respect the democratic rights of farmers and teachers who had protested peacefully.

"The government has decided to withdraw the cases on humanitarian grounds, and in accordance with democratic norms," he said.

'Goondas Act invoked'

Mr. Vijay said the Goondas Act had been invoked against farmers in Tiruvannamalai district, who had opposed the acquisition of their lands for a SIPCOT industrial park.

"Cases were filed in an inhumane manner against farmers who had fought against the acquisition of waterbodies and agricultural lands, as it would affect their livelihoods. The cases



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay

had been pending. Now, the government has decided to withdraw them," he said.

Standard practice: DMK Senior DMK leader T.K.S. Elangovan downplayed the political significance of Mr. Vijay's decision, calling it standard administrative practice.

He noted that previous administrations have routinely taken similar steps.

Mr. Elangovan explained that while police immediately register cases for property damage during agitations, governments generally do not press those charges once they consider the underlying reasons for the protests.

"That is what Mr. Vijay has also done," he added. (With PTI inputs)

Rahul's Indore event postponed after stadium nod denied: Cong.

Press Trust of India
INDORE

The Congress on Wednesday said party leader Rahul Gandhi's 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' event in Indore, earlier planned to be held on September 12, has been postponed to September 19 due to the State government's denial of permission to use a city-based stadium as the programme venue.

State Congress president Jitu Patwari made the announcement during a meeting held to take stock of the preparations for the event.

He said that the State government denied permission to hold 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here and the party will now find a new venue for the event and make preparations accordingly.

Earlier, Mr. Patwari wrote a letter to Chief Minister Mohan Yadav requesting him to make the



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi addressing a gathering during a 'Chhatron Ki Goonj' programme in Pune. FILE PHOTO: ANI

stadium available for the September 12 event.

In the letter, he said Mr. Gandhi's programme is not a typical political event, but a public dialogue focused on important issues such as the country's future, the dreams of youth, the right to education, and the security of the education system.

Nehru Stadium falls under the jurisdiction of the Indore Municipal Corporation.

Mayor Pushyamitra Bhargava said that the Madhya Pradesh High

Court has clearly stated that only sports activities or State-level government programmes can be permitted at the stadium.

Mobilising students

The Congress is trying to mobilise 50,000 students from Indore and surrounding areas for the programme.

'Chhatron Ki Goonj' is a student-dialogue campaign launched by the Congress, under which programmes are being organised in various cities across the country.

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Hundreds of candidates seeking recruitment to 3,284 Junior Assistant posts staged a protest outside the official residence of Deputy Chief Minister Brajesh Pathak on Wednesday demanding completion of the recruitment and appointment process by the Uttar Pradesh Subordinate Services Selection Commission (UPSSSC).

The job aspirants held placards and accused the State government of neglecting their grievances and delaying the process.

Following the protest, Mr. Pathak met the aspirants and said he has instructed officials to resolve the issue immediately. "I met the candidates and spoke to the UPSSSC Chairman. I have instructed that their issues be resolved immediately. Our government stands firmly with students and the youth. We are working on meeting



Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak (right) meeting aspirants after they staged a protest outside his residence on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

their demands," he said.

The Deputy Chief Minister added that all students desire a speedy resolution. "I have just directed the UPSSSC Chairman to ensure that the typing examination is held promptly in accordance with the students' demands," he said.

'False assurances'

The aspirants said they have been waiting for the typing test for a long time.

"We met the Deputy Chief Minister regarding

the delay in the recruitment drive. The typing test has not taken place yet. Now, they are suggesting to hold it in December. We want the test to be held as soon as possible. However, the commission keeps giving us false assurances," said Abhinav Mishra, one of the protesting aspirants.

He said though the protesters appealed to the Deputy Chief Minister and he later facilitated a discussion, the UPSSSC officials only said the matter would

history of Lawrence Bishnoi, who was lodged in Tihar and Mandoli prisons while facing trial before being shifted to Sabarmati Central Jail in Gujarat, also highlights the relevance of allowing undertrials to be transferred between States.

Prison promises

Former inmates who spent five to 20 years in Delhi prisons told *The Hindu* that they were approached with offers of money, help in court cases and other favours. "During my first interim bail, after four and a half years in prison, I was offered ₹10 lakh to carry out a 'task' and promised help with my case," said a former inmate lodged in a murder case.

Sunil Kumar Gupta, a former legal adviser, superintendent and spokesperson

of Central Jail in Tihar, said gang members identify 'useful' inmates and exploit vulnerabilities such as financial distress, pending cases and drug dependence. "Once trust is established, recruits may be used to move contraband, extort money or carry out crimes after release or while on bail," he said.

Mr. Gupta said transferring gang leaders could disrupt such networks, but warned that influential prisoners could try to manipulate the process.

'Not all gaps closed'

Technology, meanwhile, has not closed all the gaps. A prison official, speaking on condition of anonymity, said inmates continued to find ways around mobile phone jammers by exploiting weak coverage, using newer networks or having

equipment tampered with, sometimes with staff support. Contraband can enter through visitors, parcels and mail, over prison walls or during court movements, the official said. "Prisons need better screening equipment, including body scanners and X-ray systems," he added.

Mr. Gupta said staff shortages, inadequate training and the perception of jail duty as a "punishment posting" have made prisons vulnerable to collusion.

While the proposed transfers may help reduce some links between gangs inside and outside prisons, their effectiveness would also depend on addressing issues such as staff shortages, corruption and gaps in supervision, which can allow such networks to persist or adapt.

Inside Delhi prisons: a web of gangs, collusion and proposed transfers

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

On April 6 this year, a clash among inmates inside Mandoli jail left a 22-year-old murder accused seriously injured. Three months later, the Delhi government's Anti-Corruption Branch arrested 11 people, including seven prison officials, in an alleged extortion and bribery racket involving prisons in Tihar, Rohini and Mandoli.

The incidents have again put the functioning of Delhi's prisons under scrutiny amid concerns over gang rivalries, contraband, staff collusion and communication between inmates and associates outside. The concern is particularly significant given the presence of several high-profile gangsters and or-



Gangsters such as Neeraj Bawana (left) and Lawrence Bishnoi (right) have been lodged in Tihar and Mandoli prisons while facing trial between 2021 and 2023. FILE PHOTOS

ganised criminals across the city's three major prison complexes. Gangsters such as Neeraj Bawana and Chhota Rajan have been lodged in Tihar jail since 2015, while Hashim Baba has been there since 2019 and is allegedly operating his syndicate from behind bars. Anmol Bishnoi has also been in high-security custody in Tihar jail since November 2025.

Against this backdrop,

the Delhi government is considering transferring "hardened and notorious" prisoners, including undertrial gangsters, organised criminals and other high-risk inmates, to prisons in other States under the Transfer of Prisoners (Punjab Amendment) Act, 2025. The proposed move would allow undertrials to be transferred to prisons outside the State besides convicted prisoners. The

Maharashtra roll: Cong. seeks extension of time for filing of objections

Press Trust of India
MUMBAI

With 2.06 crore names in Maharashtra not figuring in the draft electoral roll following a special intensive revision (SIR), the State Congress on Wednesday demanded that sufficient time be given for filing claims and objections.

It also demanded that the hearing process be made more convenient, and the entire exercise be conducted in a transparent manner.

2.06 cr. names deleted

More than 2.06 crore names, accounting for 21.14% of the State's previous voter base, have not

figured in the draft electoral roll. The draft roll currently has more than 7.71 crore names (78.86% of the previous electorate), comprising 3.95 crore men, 3.75 crore women, and 3,087 third-genders, according to State election authorities.

The Congress sought extension of the deadline for claims and objections until November 30.

The current period from August 31 to September 30 is insufficient. Moreover, the Ganesh festival falls during this period, when many citizens travel to their native places. Therefore, the deadline for filing claims and objections should be extended until November 30, 2026, it said.

Formulate rules for fishing vessel transit to EEZ, SC directs T.N.

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Seeking cooperative federalism between the Centre and the State to regulate purse seine fishing, the Supreme Court on Wednesday directed the Tamil Nadu government to frame rules to create a “specified channel” or official navigation corridor under the Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020 for transit of vessels from its territorial waters to Exclusive Economic Zones (EEZ) for fishing using such nets.

The direction by a Division Bench headed by Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe was part of a judgment which considered applications concerning the rights of fishermen using purse seine nets to access the EEZ beyond the territorial waters of the State of Tamil Nadu.

The State had expressed concern in court that fishers could employ purse seine nets within the 12 nautical miles of territorial waters under the guise of fishing in the EEZ. It would be difficult for the State to regulate such activities. On the other hand, the fishers had argued that Tamil Nadu was invoking the 2020 Rules to prevent them from even carrying these purse seine nets to the EEZ for fishing beyond 12 nautical miles which is outside the realm of the State’s regulation.

But the court said fishing within and outside the territorial waters of the State was covered by Tamil Nadu Marine Fishing Regu-



There is no conflict between the EEZ Rules of the Union and the Marine Fishery Regulation Rules, 2020 of the State of Tamil Nadu
SUPREME COURT

lation Rules, 2020, and the Central law of Sustainable Harnessing of Fisheries in the Exclusive Economic Zone Rules (EEZ Rules), 2025. The 2020 Rules regulate fishing within Tamil Nadu’s territorial waters and the use of gear.

The EEZ Rules contemplate the issuance of ‘access pass’ to fishing vessels permitted in the EEZ. Upholding both the 2020 and 2025 Rules, the court directed that the “rights and liabilities of the parties will now be governed as per the relevant laws, EEZ Rules, 2025 and the Tamil Nadu Marine Fishing Regulation Rules, 2020”.

“We now have the entire legal regime through which purse seine fishing can be regulated in the EEZ, while addressing the concerns of the State government within the territorial waters... There is no conflict between the EEZ Rules of the Union and the Marine Fishery Regulation Rules, 2020 of the State of Tamil Nadu,” the court observed.

Agniveer involvement ruled out in military weapon theft

Military Intelligence has joined the investigation into the missing service weapons from 20 Madras Regiment premises in Secunderabad; probe being conducted from an undisclosed location

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

The Malkajgiri Police have reportedly ruled out the involvement of Agniveers in the theft of service weapons and ammunition from the 20 Madras Regiment premises in Bollaram, Secunderabad Cantonment, even as the investigation continues under heightened secrecy inside the defence area.

Military Intelligence has also joined the investigation into the theft, with the probe being conducted from within the defence area at an undisclosed location to maintain confi-



Missing gear: The stolen service weapons include four AK-203 assault rifles and six 9mm pistols. IMAGE FOR REPRESENTATION

dentiality. Sources said even staff at the Bollaram Police Station were not aware of the status of the investigation or the details of the probe.

The restrictions on shar-

ing information come amid heightened security following the theft of four AK-203 assault rifles, an INSAS IBI rifle, six 9 mm Auto 1A pistols and a civilian 6.35-bore pistol from the

Army premises. A passive night-vision binocular and more than 1,800 rounds of ammunition were also reported missing.

The discrepancy was detected around 7.50 a.m. on Monday when the Kote and Battalion Magazine was opened and the locks were found broken. The weapons and ammunition were last physically accounted for around 6 p.m. on August 30.

The Army subsequently reverified its weapon and ammunition holdings and accounting records, searched authorised storage areas and adjoining premises and checked issue and receipt registers.

Sunni leader’s observations on women unsuitable for modern Keralam, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Rejecting Sunni leader Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar’s recent controversial opinions against the participation of women in public platforms, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said his comments are unsuitable for modern and progressive Keralam.

Addressing a press conference in Thiruvananthapuram on Wednesday

after the Cabinet meeting, Mr. Satheesan said that neither the Congress nor the State government can agree with such a stand that belongs to the 19th century.

“Even Islamic history and its scriptures say that women have a place in public spaces. Such comments are a result of misinterpretation of Islam. Khadija, the first wife of the Prophet, was a businesswoman, while Ayesha, another wife, had led an



V.D. Satheesan

army in a war. Women’s voices were respected in the court of Khalifa Umar,” Mr. Satheesan said.

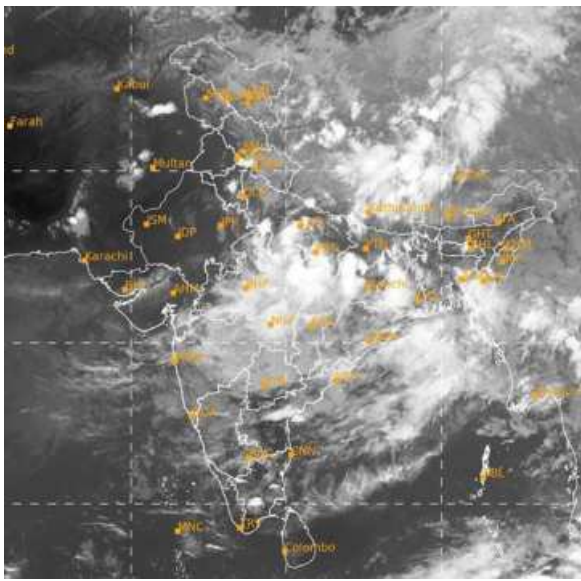
Meanwhile, the Kerala Muslim Jamaat con-

demned Mr. Satheesan’s remarks that Mr. Aboobacker Musliar had misinterpreted Islam. It demanded that the Chief Minister withdraw the statement and apologise to the Muslim community.

The Muslim Jamaat said Mr. Satheesan had misunderstood Islamic history and commented on them without properly considering their context. Such remarks, it said, were unbecoming of the office of the Chief Minister.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, Sub Himalayan West Bengal, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and Vidarbha

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		31.5	25.5	Kurnool		36.3	26.3
Ahmedabad		0.4	34.4		35	30.5	25.2
Aizawl		24.5	29.2		39.5		27.1
Bengaluru		30.4	20.7	Mangaluru		3	30.9
Bhopal		27.6	23.2	Mumbai		4.5	31.5
Bhubaneswar		34.2	26.1	Mysuru		32.0	18.8
Chandigarh		34.7	25.9	New Delhi		31.3	28.0
Chennai		37.2	28.6	Patna		34.4	29.9
Coimbatore		34.0	22.6	Port Blair		7.4	31.2
Dehradun		7.6	29.9	Prayagraj		47.1	29.0
Gangtok		19	20.3	Puducherry		36.4	27.8
Goa		10	31.4	Pune		30	22.8
Guwahati		6	32.5	Raipur		1.4	29.0
Hubballi		28.0	21.0	Ranchi		40	26.7
Hyderabad		6	32.2	Shillong		9.2	22.0
Imphal		3	26.9	Shimla		42.8	21
Jaipur		34.8	26.8	Srinagar		0.3	29.6
Kochi		3	30.6	Thiruvananthapuram		33.0	24.5
Kohima		3	26.0	Tiruchirappalli		40.1	27.6
Kolkata		27	32.0	Vijayawada		33.2	27.0
Kozhikode		33.4	25.5	Visakhapatnam		33.8	28.4

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		23	36	20		81	
Bengaluru		23	17	58		115	
Chennai			14	52		46	
Delhi		25	43	49		67	
Hyderabad		11	17	26		79	
Kolkata			6	29	40		227
Lucknow			7	17	50		32
Mumbai			4	10	15		26
Pune		10	18	75		28	
Visakhapatnam						54	

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

INBRIEF



Aero India 2027 to be held in Bengaluru from February 8

Aero India, Asia’s largest air show and among the world’s premier aerospace and defence exhibitions, will return for its 16th edition at Air Force Station, Yelahanka, in Bengaluru from February 8 to 12, 2027. Exhibitor registrations are scheduled to begin on September 3, 2026. A major attraction of the event will be aerial displays by the Indian Air Force and participating international flying teams. Aero India 2027 is being organised by the Department of Defence Production under the Ministry of Defence.

Keralam seeks technical study of Mullaperiyar Dam

Keralam has demanded a rigorous, long-term technical evaluation of the Mullaperiyar Dam before the five-member comprehensive safety panel. The State submitted an eight-page written document detailing its safety concerns. Both Keralam and Tamil Nadu presented their arguments during the meeting, officials said. The demand comes as the panel began inspection of the main dam, baby dam, earthen dam, and spillway on Tuesday. The panel’s chairman, former NHPG CMD Balraj Joshi, said that the committee will submit its report in two weeks.

Juvenile held by Bengaluru Police for posing as IAS officer

A juvenile has been apprehended for allegedly cheating people by creating fake Facebook accounts in the names of IAS and IPS officers and seeking money from victims. The case came to light after a person was allegedly cheated through a fake Facebook account created using the name and photograph of Electronics City sub-division DCP Narayan. Following a complaint at the Hebbagodi police station near Bengaluru, the police traced the fraud network to Kotakur village in Rajasthan. A juvenile allegedly involved in the racket was taken into custody.

Godavari reaches north A.P. through Polavaram canal

Hareesh.P
PAYAKARAOPET

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu on Wednesday laid out a road map for augmenting water supply to the Uttarandhra region through various projects and interlinking of rivers.

Releasing the Godavari water to the north Andhra region through the Polavaram Left Main Canal at PL Puram village in Anakapalli district on Wednesday, he said: “I had promised to bring the Godavari water to Uttarandhra and fulfilled it,” he said. He thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the merger of seven mandals in Telangana with Andhra Pradesh, without which Polavaram project would have remained a dream.

The project, executed at a cost of ₹4,192 crore, will



N. Chandrababu Naidu joins the prayers before opening the gates of Polavaram Left Main Canal in Anakapalli on Wednesday.

ensure water for irrigating four lakh acres, drinking water to 9.23 lakh people, and will meet the industrial needs of East Godavari, Kakinada, Konaseema, Anakapalli, and Visakhapatnam districts. He said 72% of Polavaram project works had been completed by 2019, but the previous government had neglected the project.

“With the blessings of Annavaram Satyanarayana

Swamy, we have brought the Godavari river water to Anakapalli. By next year, water will reach near Simhadri Appanna (Simhachalam in Visakhapatnam) and Suryanarayana Swamy at Arasavalli in future, realising the goal of interlinking of the Godavari with the Vamsadhara river. We will offer ‘Jala Harathi’ to every acre of land by interlinking the Godavari with the Krishna,” he said.

BJP urges Karnataka CM to sack Ministers over graft allegation

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A recent letter to Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar by Congress MLA Ashok Kumar Rai, accusing two engineers of Karnataka Rural Infrastructure Development Limited (KRIDL) of collecting extra charges from contractors stating that it has to be given to the Dakshina Kannada district in-charge Minister and the department Minister, has now taken a serious turn with the BJP urging the Chief Minister to sack these two Ministers.

Addressing a press conference in Bengaluru on Wednesday, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly R. Ashoka urged the government to immediately dismiss the two Ministers who are allegedly taking

bribes and also hand over the investigation to CBI.

In the letter, Mr. Rai has stated that an extra 7% of money is being collected from contractors in KRIDL, allegedly to be given to these Ministers and that contractors who questioned it are being threatened.

‘Commission raj’

Mr. Ashok alleged that after the Congress came to power, officials were acting in an unruly manner and the government was running a “commission raj.”

“If ₹100 is released, only ₹30 worth of work is done. The remaining 70% goes as commission. When we made the allegation, they asked for documents. Now a Congress MLA himself has spoken about the commission,” he said.

Siddaramaiah backs drive to nurture OBC leadership

Nagesh Prabhu
BENGALURU

Former Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah is backing the formation of Shudra Seva Sanghas in universities and colleges across the State to draw young people from Other Backward Classes (OBCs) into public life and help develop a new generation of political leaders. The initiative assumes significance against the backdrop of the growing visibility of Gen Z-led protests in the country.

Mr. Siddaramaiah recently inaugurated a Shudra Seva Sangha in Bengaluru, and attended the sangha meetings with the objective of involving students belonging to OBCs in social and political activities and nurturing leadership qualities among them.

Pichavaram mangroves valued at ₹2,485 crore: study

K.C. Deepika
BENGALURU

How valuable are mangroves? A recent study of the Pichavaram mangrove ecosystem in Tamil Nadu estimated its total economic value (TEV) at ₹2,485.38 crore, with a per-hectare value of ₹1.83 crore, reflecting the ecological, economic, and social benefits it provides.

The Pichavaram Mangrove Forest is deemed one of the most ecologically significant coastal wetland ecosystems in India and plays a vital role in supporting biodiversity conservation, fisheries productivity, coastal protection, climate regulation,

blue carbon sequestration, and livelihood security for coastal communities.

“Mangrove ecosystems provide a wide range of provisioning, regulating, supporting, and cultural ecosystem services that contribute significantly to ecological sustainability and human well-being. Despite their importance, many ecosystem services remain undervalued in conventional development planning because several ecological benefits are non-market in nature and are not reflected in market transactions,” says the study. “Economic valuation and blue carbon assessment of ecosystem services (ESV) in the Pichavaram



Green gold: Pichavaram Mangrove Forest is a highly significant coastal wetland ecosystem in India. FILE PHOTO

Mangrove Forest”.

The study, by M. Balasubramanian, Associate Professor, Centre for Ecological Economics and Natural Resources, Institute for Social and Economic Change, Bengaluru, was funded by

the Deputy Conservator of Forests, Forest Genetics Division, Coimbatore. It was based on primary and secondary data; primary information was collected from 302 households across five mangrove-de-

pendent villages: MGR Thittu, Kalaingar Nagar, Chinnavaikal, Patriadi, and Mudasalodai.

Carbon sink

“The blue carbon assessment highlights the critical role of the Pichavaram mangroves as a significant natural carbon sink and a valuable climate regulation asset,” says the study.

The analysis further revealed that mangrove sediments constitute an even more substantial carbon reservoir. The average soil organic carbon stock of 251.14 tonnes of carbon per hectare was estimated to generate an economic value of ₹90.24 lakh per hectare, resulting in a total soil

organic carbon value of ₹1,224.63 crore. When vegetation and soil carbon pools are combined, the total blue carbon asset value of the Pichavaram Mangrove Ecosystem is estimated at ₹1,612.40 crore

The study recommends the integration of ecosystem service valuation into coastal development planning and environmental decision-making, the recognition of mangroves as key nature-based solutions for climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction, and the development of blue carbon financing mechanisms, carbon credit programmes, and Payment for Ecosystem Services schemes.



Orthodoxy redux

Religion is oft used as a tool to suppress women in the public sphere

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar’s directive to restrict Muslim women’s participation in public celebrations has unsettled Keralam because it strikes at a fundamental question: women’s right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad’s 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can intrude into the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such departures. That argument holds no weight. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to conform to the values enshrined in the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause “chaos”, the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is at variance with constitutional equality and Keralam’s long struggle to expand the space in public life for women disadvantaged by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a monolith. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a counter-current of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam’s main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely guarded until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan rubbished the decree as antediluvian. The Indian Union Muslim League’s silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women’s forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot equivocate when women’s right to public participation is open to challenge. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, *Vande Mataram* and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not confer on religious authorities the right to regulate women’s freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were awash with videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram’s remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while making exceptions for orthodoxy.

Many layers

Farmers need more storage facilities and better distribution networks

Since the 1960s, India has developed a balancing-act habit: between keeping food prices affordably low for consumers and assuring farmers of remunerative prices, with the state’s interventions focused on managing this volatility in the short term. This is also why the government banned onion exports from December 2023 to May 2024, then imposed a \$550/tonne minimum export price and a 40% export duty, reduced the duty to 20% in September 2024, and finally abolished it in April 2025. But erratic weather together with the lack of long-term relief has rendered the act increasingly awkward. From farmers’ point of view, the government often changes its mind after they have made important production-related decisions based on the expected price. On the other hand, during the bounteous *rabi* harvest, onion farmers in Maharashtra, the country’s principal supplier, had argued that the Centre’s procurement price of ₹12.35/kg would not cover the costs of cultivation. The Centre subsequently raised the price to up to ₹26.45/kg, but many farmers – including some who had had to sell at ₹1/kg earlier because of low quality and lack of storage, among other factors – were unable to capture the higher value, exposing the limits of intervening after prices have already collapsed and not reaching all farmers or grades of produce.

While the government has alluded to some price manipulation, the dominant issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking proactive measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less erratic trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the *kharif* crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large buffers, are simply among the pressures that highlighted the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu’s targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is commendably designed to discourage hoarding while allowing private retail prices to cool down. However, the State must also guard against the pitfalls of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network – its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more susceptible than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% – and if the need arises to persist with the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly exhausted, more so given this year’s high storage losses of around 30%.

On August 25, 2026, in Beijing, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and China’s Foreign Minister Wang Yi held the 25th round of talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) on the India-China boundary question. That evening’s readouts from both sides were anodyne and notably avoided a phrase that has dominated this discussion for a year: early harvest. A day later, the two sides released an “Eight Points of Outcomes and Consensus”. Point 3 restored and enhanced the phrase: the Expert Group on Boundary Delimitation and the Working Group on Border Management, set up under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) a year ago, would “respectively advance discussions on an Early and Substantial Harvest of boundary delimitation and Border Management”. Their first task, it adds, is to agree on their own terms of reference, one year after they were constituted, suggesting that whatever is being contemplated remains at an early stage

An uncertain Early Harvest

The phrase “Early and Substantial Harvest” is significant because it is India’s own coinage. When Beijing first proposed settling the Sikkim Sector alone, India’s considered response, around 2019, was a counter-proposal on an “Early and Substantial Harvest” covering the Sikkim Sector together with the entire Middle Sector, with the boundary delineated along the watershed. China rejected the proposal. In subsequent discussions on an “Early Harvest,” China reportedly agreed only to include the Sikkim Sector and some undisputed areas of the Middle Sector – a proposal that was unacceptable to India.

The exact Indian formulation has now resurfaced in a joint document. This could mean that Beijing has accepted India’s terms – which this writer doubts – as that would involve China giving up its claim to approximately 2,450 square kilometres of territory in the Middle Sector, all south of the watershed boundary (Barahoti, Giu-Kaurik, Nilang-Jadhang, Sangcha Malla, and Lapthal). It could equally mean something the Indian side had rejected earlier: an “agreement with holes”, a settlement nominally covering both sectors but confined to stretches where the claims already coincide, leaving the trijunctions and contested pockets of the Middle Sector undefined.

If that is the case, we will have the same asymmetric outcome as with a Sikkim-only settlement – India conceding ground where its position is strong, without any progress in the Eastern and Western Sectors, where China maintains its hardline position, “dong tiao xi rang”, meaning “meaningful adjustments by India in the East and corresponding concessions by China in the West”. It would also jettison a key provision (Article III) of the 2005 Agreement on



Ashok K. Kantha

Former Ambassador of India to China; Subhas Chandra Bose Chair Professor of International Relations at Chanakya University, Bengaluru, and the lead Indian negotiator for the Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for Boundary Settlement (2005)

India-China boundary talks suggest movement, but hard questions remain over strategic costs and concessions

Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for the Settlement of the India-China Boundary, which calls for a “package settlement ...covering all sectors of the India-China boundary”, opting instead to bank the easy gains immediately while leaving the hard issues open on China’s terms. The package clause exists precisely because the boundary’s four sectors are strategically interlinked, requiring cross-sector give and take.

No open-and-shut case

The Sikkim Sector is also not the open-and-shut case that some suggest. The two sides agree that the Anglo-Chinese Convention of 1890 is the “basis of the alignment” of the boundary in this sector. However, Article I of the Convention contains two stipulations that are mutually contradictory. Its first sentence makes the watershed crest the boundary, while its second names Mount Gipmochi as the starting point on the Bhutan frontier. Yet, British Indian maps of 1907 and 1913 placed the trijunction not at Gipmochi but roughly 6.5 kilometres to its north, on the true watershed crest. India and Bhutan read the watershed principle as controlling and place the trijunction at Batang La; China seizes on the literal reference to Gipmochi to push the trijunction southwards, onto the Jampheri Ridge. A Sikkim delimitation built on the 1890 text, unless it repudiates Gipmochi, would be read by Beijing as conceding the southern trijunction.

Even a trijunction-reserved settlement would strip India of the standing to counsel Bhutan against a bilateral deal, having itself settled out of turn nearby. China’s “package proposal” to Bhutan – relinquishing roughly 495 sq km of claims in the north in exchange for Bhutan ceding about 269 sq km in the northwest, including the Doklam Plateau – would gain fresh momentum, deepening China’s presence in the Chumbi Valley and opening a path to the Jampheri Ridge, from which the entire Siliguri Corridor, India’s sole overland link to its northeastern States, would come under direct observation. This is not hypothetical: since the 2017 Doklam standoff, China has spent years building roads, villages, and military facilities across western Bhutan, gaining de facto control over Doklam.

A genuine “Early and Substantial Harvest” requires three things. First, delineation must proceed on the highest-watershed principle across the entire stretch in both sectors, rather than selectively along segments where the two positions already converge, which would serve no purpose for India. Second, trijunction points, at Batang La and any comparable third-country-adjacent points in the Middle Sector, must be explicitly excluded from the Expert Group’s mandate and settled only in consultation with the country concerned, as stipulated in the 2012 Common Understanding between the two SRs. However, unless the highest-watershed principle is accepted, silence

Reducing India’s exposure to U.S. tariff risks



Himanshu Jaiswal

Consultant at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress, New Delhi

The Lindsey O. Graham Act puts India under pressure, but export diversification and domestic reforms can cushion shocks

the strategy has helped secure supplies, it carries diplomatic costs, particularly in managing ties with the United States, which seeks to strongly discourage these imports. The U.S. Russia Sanctions Act reflects this pressure.

On July 24, before the bill’s introduction, the U.S. imposed forced-labour tariffs on 60 countries, including India, under Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974, imposing an additional 10% tariff, a replacement of the expired 10% duty under Section 122, on India. If the Russia Sanctions Act becomes law, India’s cumulative tariff could reach 110%, making it one of the most heavily tariffed countries. Such high tariffs could affect India’s price competitiveness in the U.S., a major export market, leading to economic losses. China’s cumulative tariff could reach 112.5%, as both countries are major importers of Russian crude.

Trade simulations and results

To analyse the trade dynamics and possible way forward for India, two global trade simulations were conducted using the GTAP dataset and model, a global general equilibrium model that captures global linkages and country-level shocks. The first (sanction scenario) models a 110% U.S. tariff on India, with other countries facing forced-labour tariffs and China facing 112.5%. The second (diversification scenario) applies the same tariffs while India pursues export diversification, proxied by a full India-European Union free trade agreement (FTA).

The simulation results suggest that the proposed U.S. sanctions could have adverse consequences for the Indian economy. Under the sanction scenario, India’s welfare declines by nearly \$47 billion, while GDP, output, domestic demand, exports, and imports all contract. Aggregate exports fall by 5.1% and imports by 5.2%, reflecting disrupted trade flows and weaker

on the trijunction will, on the ground, be filled in Beijing’s favour in Bhutan. Third, the terms of reference for the Expert Group must extend India’s 2019 proposal in good faith, rather than dilute it beyond recognition.

Several questions about these negotiations remain unanswered. The Chinese readout of August 25 reiterates a commitment to a “package” settlement, but how will that commitment be reconciled with a piecemeal approach to settlement? How is the setting up of an Expert Group on Delimitation consistent with the instructions given to the SRs in Article X of the 2005 Agreement, which require them to “continue consultations in an earnest manner with the objective of arriving at an agreed framework for a boundary settlement, which will provide the basis for the delineation and demarcation of the India-China boundary to be subsequently undertaken by civil and military officials and surveyors of the two sides”? There is no agreed framework yet, but it is proposed to commence the process of “delimitation”, a term that the Chinese use interchangeably with “demarcation”. Indeed, the 2005 Agreement does not use the term “delimitation” at all. Will the SRs earnestly pursue negotiations on the “agreed framework”, or will they, in effect, leave it in abeyance while officials grapple with a partial delimitation exercise without such a framework? The other elements of the Eight Points – additional meeting points and hotlines for the General Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle Sectors, continued pilgrimage and border trade, and a September meeting on trans-border rivers – are useful, incremental confidence-building measures. But they belong to a different track from boundary settlement and should not be conflated in public discussion.

The Eight Points are silent on the Medog County project on the Yarlung Tsangpo River, while referring to both sides agreeing to “maintain communication on (trans-border river) issues, including hydrological data sharing and renewal of the relevant MoUs”, without reporting any progress. The September meeting should convey India’s concerns about the project – the world’s largest hydropower plant – being built close to the border in the Eastern Sector, in a highly earthquake-prone zone, a risk underscored by the flash floods in Nepal on August 26.

Avoid optics

Two points bear reiteration. First, the 2005 agreement – the only substantive outcome of 23 years of SR talks – must not be diluted; China has sought to reinterpret and undermine it since its conclusion. Second, Indian negotiators must guard against the temptation to project contrived progress. Diplomacy that trades long-term strategic interests for short-term optics is self-defeating.

economic activity. The results indicate that a prolonged tariff-based confrontation with the U.S. could impose substantial costs on India’s growth and trade performance.

The picture changes considerably when India responds through export diversification. With a functional India-EU FTA, the economy turns around despite the same tariff environment. Welfare improves by \$26.3 billion, GDP turns positive, and sectoral output and domestic demand recover by around 1%. Aggregate exports increase by 3.1%, while imports rise by a moderate 2.6%, indicating stronger production and trade integration with alternative markets.

The findings suggest that even if India continues procuring crude from Russia to strengthen its energy security, the adverse economic effects of U.S. tariffs can be mitigated to a large extent through export diversification. The India-EU FTA, used here as a proxy for diversification, demonstrates that India must increasingly look beyond the U.S. and expand its presence in alternative markets, even as the U.S. remains one of its largest export destinations.

The strategy to pursue

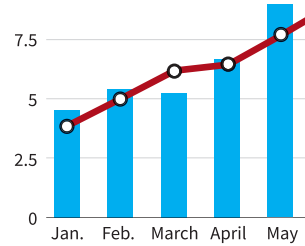
However, diversification is not a panacea. It depends on the ability of other markets to absorb additional Indian exports. Without adequate external demand, diversification may remain limited.

Therefore, export diversification must be complemented by sustained domestic reforms, including trade facilitation, removal of non-tariff barriers, improved logistics and standards, and movement up the goods quality ladder. Such a strategy would not only enhance India’s resilience to future geopolitical shocks but also strengthen its long-term export competitiveness.

The views expressed are personal

India’s crude import from Russia

Quantity (MMT)
Share in total crude imports (%)



Source: Department of Commerce, Govt. of India

Impact of tariffs and export diversification

	Sanction scenario	Diversification scenario
Welfare (\$ billion)	-46.6	26.3
Change in GDP (%)	-0.02	0.01
Sectoral output (%)	-1.9	1.2
Domestic demand (%)	-1.8	1
Aggregate export (%)	-5.1	3.1
Aggregate import (%)	-5.2	2.6

Source: Writer’s analysis using GTAP

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The north-south lens

The main article (Editorial page, September 2) risks turning a complex federal question into a simplistic north-versus-south narrative. India’s political influence has never been determined by geography alone; it reflects population, electoral mandates, governance, economic contribution and the ability of States to build national

coalitions. The southern States continue to exercise considerable political, economic and institutional influence, while several leaders from the region have shaped national policy. Portraying elected southern governments as “suppliant” or “submissive” is subjective and needlessly polarising. Delimitation deserves rigorous constitutional

debate, but framing it primarily as northern domination may deepen regional divisions rather than strengthen India’s federal compact.

Venkat Parthasarathy, Hyderabad

Austerity call

The call to citizens of the country to avoid unnecessary foreign travel and destination weddings

abroad to conserve foreign exchange would carry greater weight if accompanied by restraint from those at the top. Overseas travel by national leaders may often be necessary in the public interest, but when citizens are asked to limit their foreign expenditure, similar prudence from those in positions of authority would strengthen the message.

Leadership is not only about asking citizens to sacrifice, but also about setting an example.

Tharcus S. Fernando, Chennai

Football’s great artist

Legend Lionel Messi’s retirement from international football marks the end of one of modern sport’s most extraordinary chapters. For two decades,

he transformed football into an art form, carrying Argentina’s expectations through years of heartbreak and criticism. He leaves the international stage not only as a statistical giant, but also as a symbol of humility, grace and vision.

R. Sivakumar, Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

River-linking is not the solution

The Union Minister for Home Affairs Amit Shah's speech at the Southern Zonal Council's meeting last month in Mamallapuram has provided a few takeaways on the contentious issue of water sharing. His emphasis on the need for an early resolution of water-related issues in the southern region appears well meaning but it is easier said than done. He had also talked about linking major rivers from the Brahmaputra to the Godavari and the Cauvery, an option that, according to Mr. Shah, can ensure that India faces no water shortage for 100 years.

However, water issues are not that easy to solve. This is evident from the Centre's response to Tamil Nadu's demand for the constitution of a tribunal to adjudicate the Pennaiyar river water dispute. Aggrieved over the "violation" of the 1892 inter-State agreement by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, in November 2019, requested the Centre to establish a tribunal. It had also moved the Supreme Court with the same demand. Since then, two negotiation committees have been formed and 11 meetings held. Eventually, the top court, this February, directed the Centre to form the tribunal within a month and, later, extended the deadline by six months.

Still, the adjudicatory body is yet to be put in place. Meanwhile, the Centre asked the court whether the Pennaiyar dispute could be referred to the Mahadayi Water Dispute Tribunal instead of constituting a new tribunal. This suggestion defies logic as there is nothing in common between the two



T. Ramakrishnan

disputes. Moreover, the Interstate River Water Disputes Act, 1956 does not permit it. This suggestion in the Pennaiyar case gives the impression that the Centre is not keen on expeditiously implementing a judicial verdict in an inter-State river dispute. To cite one more example, the Central government has not yet replied to Tamil Nadu's demand, in March this year, to constitute a tribunal on the Mekedatu dam project proposed by Karnataka.

A complex problem
Given this background, one need not delve much into the complications that would entail by the inter-linking of rivers. Proponents of river linking, including Tamil Nadu, have been saying that the idea is not to disturb the natural flow of any river but to divert a portion of the surplus water. Many experts are not convinced about this argument as they are worried that once the linking is allowed, regions that benefit may become vociferous in demanding water even in times of distress, eventually depriving original beneficiaries of their quota. This is apart from the concerns over the possible adverse consequences on ecology. In fact, Keralam has been stoutly opposing the Pamba-Achankovil-Vaippar link proposal, which, if implemented, the State says, will affect the Vembanad wetland system, where the Pamba and Achankovil rivers drain. However, the National Water Development Agency says that it has accounted for improving the flow of rivers in lean periods.

In the last 130-odd years, the country has seen only a handful of inter-basin transfer projects, most of which are in south India

In the last 130-odd years, the country has seen only a handful of inter-basin transfer projects, most of which are in south India

Mullaperiyar dam, the Parambikulam-Aliyar project, the Krishna Water Supply Project, and the Indira Gandhi Canal Project are regarded as successful examples of inter-basin transfer of river waters. After the Bharatiya Janata Party's return to power in 2014, the Union government formed a Special Committee for Interlinking of Rivers, which has held over two dozen meetings since then. Needless to say, there has not been much headway.

However, in 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the ₹44,000 crore Ken-Betwa Link Project. This has now led to agitations by the tribal populations in Chhatarpur.

What the governments, both at the Centre and in States, and civil society should focus on is demand side management, instead of perpetually looking for supply side interventions. With land becoming scarcely available and resistance growing among people when it comes to land acquisition, the days of implementing mega irrigation projects are almost over. The priority has to be towards conserving what is available and using it judiciously. A massive programme of sensitising and incentivising farmers on the optimal use of water has to be launched. Indiscriminate extraction of groundwater, facilitated by schemes of free electricity for agriculture in many States, is paving the way for ecological disaster and has to be curbed immediately. Unless water conservation becomes the mantra of all the stakeholders and is practised genuinely, disputes will be the norm.

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Mental health must anchor public health

India stands at a defining moment in its journey towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. Under the Healthcare for All pillar, the government has rightly prioritised strengthening Ayushman Bharat, expanding primary healthcare, reducing out-of-pocket expenditure, and promoting preventive care. Yet there is one element that cuts across all these ambitions and determines their success: mental health.

Mental health is not a niche concern. It influences educational attainment, workforce participation, social cohesion, and physical health outcomes. A healthier and more productive India cannot be built without placing mental well-being at the centre of public health.

Major implications
The scale of the challenge is substantial. Mental illness affects one in seven Indians, with nearly 200 million people living with a diagnosable mental health condition. The contribution of mental disorders to India's total disease burden has doubled over the past three decades. Yet the national treatment gap remains 84.5%, meaning that more than four out of five people who need care do not receive it. The reasons are well known. India has only 0.3 psychiatrists per 1,00,000 population, alongside significant shortages in clinical psychologists, psychiatric social workers, and psychiatric nurses. These shortages are the result of decades during which mental health received insufficient attention, both in India and globally.

Mental disorders significantly increase the risk



Indu Bhushan

Founding CEO of India's National Health Authority and Ayushman Bharat



Anisha Padukone

CEO of The Live Love Laugh Foundation

of chronic diseases, while chronic diseases in turn increase the risk of mental illness. More than 60% of people attending primary care facilities have a diagnosable mental disorder. Rates of anxiety and depression are substantially higher among people living with diabetes, hypertension, tuberculosis, and HIV/AIDS. Ignoring mental health, therefore, undermines efforts to control non-communicable diseases and reduce healthcare expenditure.

The economic implications are equally compelling. A 2025 modelling study by researchers from PGIMER and NIMHANS estimated that integrating universal depression screening into India's primary healthcare system could generate net savings of ₹291 billion to ₹482 billion annually, equivalent to as much as 0.32% of GDP. Mental health is not a social welfare issue alone – it is also a human capital investment and an economic growth strategy.

The encouraging news is that India has already built many of the foundations required for transformation. More than 1.73 lakh sub-centres and primary health centres have been converted into Ayushman Bharat Arogya Mandirs, with mental healthcare included among the essential service packages. The District Mental Health Programme now covers more than 90% of districts. Tele-MANAS, launched in 2022, has expanded across all States and Union Territories.

Three main priorities
The task now is not to start from scratch. It is to build on this foundation at scale. First, one must empower

If India is to become a truly developed nation by 2047, mental health must move from the margins of public policy to its centre

Decoding Russia's reliance on Indian petroleum products

Ukraine's recent relentless attacks on Russia's oil refineries has led the country to rely on India for petroleum imports

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis

Recent Ukrainian attacks on Russia's oil refineries has resulted in the latter importing refined petroleum products from India in significant quantities for the first time, at least since the Russia-Ukraine war started in February 2022.

As per multiple media reports, including one by the *Press Trust of India*, Indian refiners sent about one million barrels over the last two months, alongside Turkey and Morocco. Russia's import of petroleum products from India has remained negligible in the past, accounting for less than one per cent of India's petroleum exports. The bulk of exports went to countries like the Netherlands, Australia and the UAE (**Chart 1**).

Though the Indian government's export and import-related data for the last two months is yet to be released, reports have confirmed that the country's export of refined petroleum products to Russia has sharply increased in the last two months. This has tilted the huge imbalance that existed between the two countries in oil trade, albeit marginally. India continues to remain hugely dependent on Russia for crude.

One-fourth of India's petroleum imports since January 2022 were from Russia and this number remained high before U.S. President Donald Trump imposed additional tariffs on India in October 2025 for buying crude from Russia.

Though this resulted in India sharply cutting down its crude import from Russia, the imports resumed in full swing soon after. In fact, after the U.S. and Israel launched a war with Iran in February this year, the former did a U-turn in its stance and tacitly encouraged Russian crude supplies into the market to negate the impact of Iran's blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

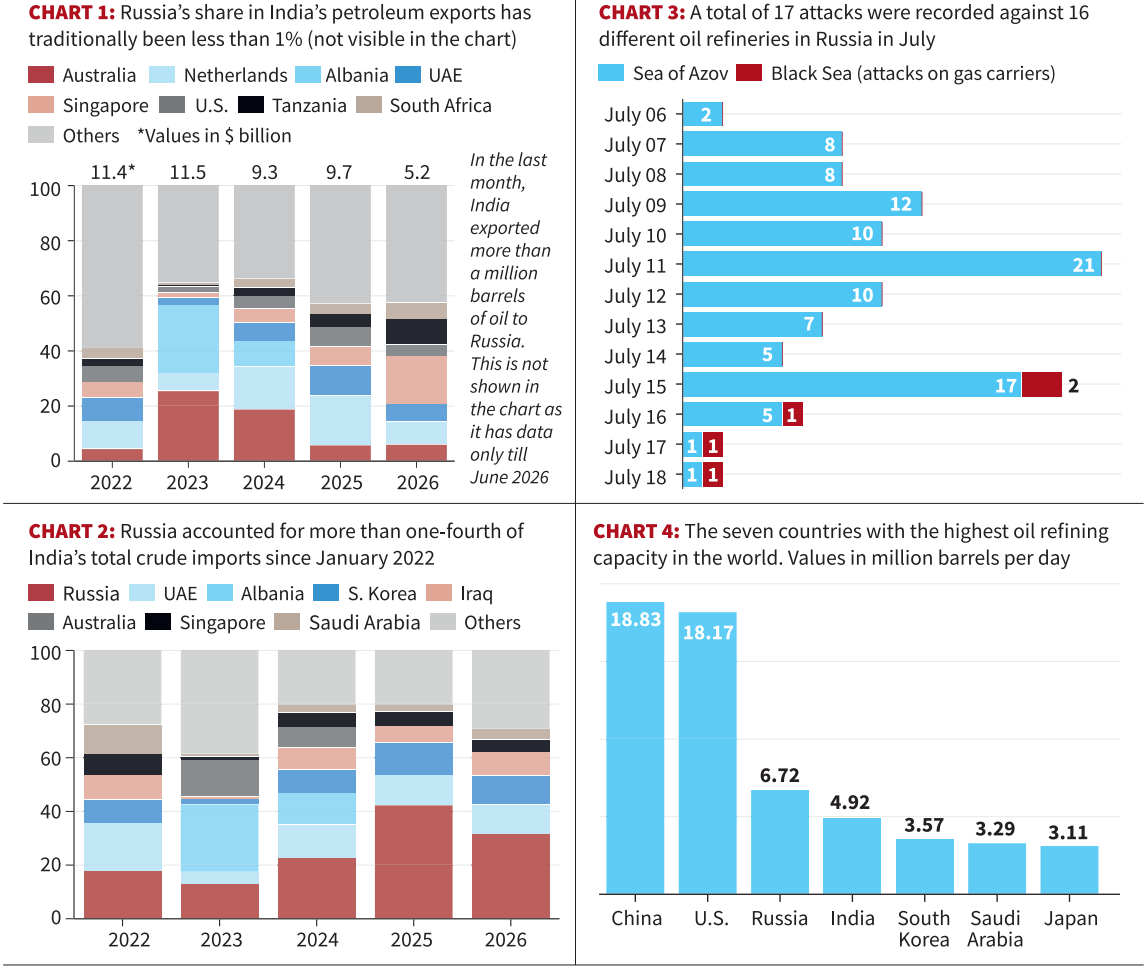
Chart 2 shows how Russia accounted for nearly one-third (31.6%) of India's crude imports as of June 2026. India imported \$531 million worth of crude from Russia in June 2026, which is roughly double that of its import from the country in January 2022, a month before Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Amid Ukraine's continued targeting of Russia's oil refining infrastructure, the Russian Federation's Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak said in July that the country would begin importing oil products to help stabilise the domestic market.

Consistent attacks

According to the International Strategic Action Network for Security, there were at least 17 attacks on 16 different oil refineries in Russia. Eight attacks were targeted at oil depots and oil pumping stations in July (**Chart 3**). Though reliable data on similar attacks in August are not available yet, they seem to have continued at the same rate, resulting in petrol and diesel shortages.

Data from the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) show that Russia's refinery crude throughput went from about 5.18 million barrels per day in Q12026 (January to March) in the beginning of the year, to about 3.88 million barrels per day in Q32026. The attacks also seem to have contributed to a surge in crude exports from Russia, as unplanned refinery outages diverted higher volumes of crude to the export market. India, which ranks fourth in oil-refining capacity in the world, has utilised Russia's sudden demand to export refined petroleum products, mainly from private refineries (**Chart 4**). Considering the time it would take for Russia to bring its refining capacity back to its earlier capacity, the surge in exports could continue, which will help India in easing its pressure on foreign exchange in the coming months.



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1976

Tip-off leads to underground vault

Madras, September 2: Sixteen exquisite bronze idols and 17 puja utensils all valued at Rs. one crore have been recovered from an underground vault in the ancient Kalyanasundarar Temple in Nallur, Papanasam taluk in Thanjavur district. The temple is under the control of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam.

Officials of the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Department and State Directorate of Archaeology, led by Dr. R. Nagaswami, Director of Archaeology, acting on a hint thrown by the temple executive searched and found the vault. A representative of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam was present during the search. The Math's records indicate that these valuable images and jewels had been deposited in the safe vault in 1942.

These rare pieces of art were retrieved earlier this week after securing an order from the State Government to rummage the underground cell in the temple precincts.

Apart from the discovery of the valuable pieces from the subterranean chamber, this probe has given a clue to the traditional method of safeguarding precious idols and ornaments of a temple and the care bestowed on preservation of art forms.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1926

Slavery in Burma frontier

Rangoon, September 2: *The Rangoon Gazette* says that the successful emancipation of slaves in Hukawng valley last season will, it is said, be followed this cold season by an expedition to that part of unadministered territory between Malikha and Nmaikha rivers, north of their junction to the Irrawaddy river and locally known as the triangle where the same system of slavery as existed in Hukawng valley still prevails. The triangles though not as extensive a territory as Hukawng valley, is more densely populated and the number of slaves to be liberated will be more numerous. It is expected that Mr. J.T.O. Barnard, Deputy Commissioner, Burma, Frontier Service, who was principally responsible for the arrangements for the emancipation of the slaves in the Hukawng valley will be placed on this duty and in charge of the expedition. *The Gazette's* statement is yet unconfirmed.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount mobilised by banks in deposits from Indian diaspora

127.23 in \$ billion. India attracted a whopping USD 127.23 billion in Foreign Currency Non-Resident (FCNR-B) deposits under the Reserve Bank's special USD-INR forex swap facility till August 31, the closing date. The RBI's special USD-INR forex swap facility was launched on June 8, 2026. PTI

Length of Manipur's border with Myanmar that has been fenced

55 in kilometres. Manipur Home Minister Govindas Konthoujam on Wednesday said that nearly 55 km out of 398 km of the State's international border with Myanmar has been fenced. Mr. Konthoujam was responding to a calling attention motion raised by Congress MLA K. Ranjit Singh on the "reported proposal for a land swap deal between India and Myanmar". PTI

Number of dengue cases recorded in Delhi till August 29

311 As many as 311 cases of dengue, 119 of malaria and 22 of chikungunya have been recorded in Delhi till August 29 this year, while no death has been reported due to any of the diseases. Delhi recorded its highest monthly tally of dengue cases this year in August, with 90 infections reported during the month, a Municipal Corporation of Delhi report says. PTI

Number of special trains operated during Onam season this year

180 As many as 180 special train services were operated in the Thiruvananthapuram Division during the Onam festive season this year, carrying an additional 2,45,823 passengers, railway officials said here on Wednesday. The division recorded an overall punctuality of 94.67% in August this year, compared to 91% during the same month last year. PTI

Applications received for police recruitment in Himachal Pradesh

98 in thousands. The State Public Service Commission has received over 98,000 applications for police constable recruitment till September 1, 2026, Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu told the Assembly on Wednesday. He said the September 5 deadline for application would not be extended. PTI

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Constitutional faultlines in FCRA Bill

The FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 provides for a 'Designated Authority' to oversee the management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets when an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled or ceases to exist; raising questions about the extent of State intervention and the need for sufficient safeguards against overreach

LETTER & SPIRIT

Thajaswini C.B.
Siddharth Dev Prasad

It is hard to deny that the state has a legitimate concern in regulating foreign contributions in India, as foreign donations raise issues concerning national security, transparency in democracy, and public accountability. For decades, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act has been the instrument through which this interest has been pursued. However, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 raises a different question altogether. It goes beyond regulating foreign contributions, to the extent to which the state may intervene in assets and institutional activities associated with them.

The fundamental issue, therefore, is not a debate between civil society and national security. It is about where the State, in pursuit of its legitimate regulatory goal, may cross the boundary from regulating foreign contributions to exercising undue executive control over the institutions that receive them.

The Bill's most important aspect is a statutory framework for the vesting, supervision, management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets through a 'Designated Authority'. Where an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled, surrendered or ceases to exist, including due to non-renewal, the Central government may appoint an authority to which the foreign contribution and assets created from it may vest provisionally. The measure is framed as an accountability mechanism to prevent the diversion or abuse of such properties.

Expansion of statutory consequences However, the constitutional difficulty lies elsewhere.

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. If there are any violations in this regard, registrations can be withdrawn,



Opposition MPs protest in New Delhi on April 1, demanding the withdrawal of the FCRA Amendment Bill.

cancellation can follow continuing non-compliance, and penalties can attach to the diversion or misappropriation of foreign contributions. The Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration. Importantly, the existing FCRA law already contains a provision for vesting assets created from foreign funds upon cancellation. What is new is the detailed statutory framework for their provisional vesting, possession, management, restoration and ultimately, permanent vesting and disposal.

In case of cancellation, surrender, or cessation of registration, the government may, through the Designated Authority, take possession of and manage assets created from foreign contributions and, where considered necessary or expedient in the public interest, undertake the management of the concerned organisation's activities. This is not merely a change in administrative policy; it raises a constitutional question about the extent to which a statute regulating foreign contributions may permit executive authorities to assume possession and, in specified circumstances, management of institutional assets and activities.

Even if the dichotomy between ownership and custody may have some legal relevance, its practical consequences are not. An entity whose success is dependent on the continuity of management will place greater emphasis on control than ownership. Ownership may remain formally undisturbed, but a change in management control fundamentally alters the relationship between the institution and the state. A hospital, school or laboratory is not made effective by ownership alone; it depends on its independence to administer, for charitable ends, what it owns.

Evaluation of proportionality

This is where the doctrine of constitutional proportionality may be relevant. The Supreme Court has repeatedly held that even where the state pursues a legitimate objective, the means it adopts must bear a reasonable connection to that objective and must maintain an appropriate balance between the public purpose and the burden imposed on rights. The amendment raises difficult questions when measured against the said rationale. If the consequence of losing FCRA registration is the provisional vesting of assets in, and potentially the

management of institutional activities by a government-appointed authority, the safeguards attending that transfer must be commensurately robust.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting. The Bill provides for the restoration of assets when registration is obtained, renewed, or restored within the prescribed period, as well as mechanisms for revision and judicial appeal. The constitutional question is whether these safeguards are sufficiently clear, timely and effective.

This concern becomes more significant against the broader regulatory landscape. Over the past decade, thousands of FCRA registrations have ceased to operate for reasons ranging from non-renewal to alleged statutory violations. While many regulatory actions may be justified, the Bill may increase the consequences arising from the cessation of registration. What might previously have been limited to the loss of eligibility to receive foreign funds could, under the proposed framework, extend to provisional management and, if registration is not restored within the prescribed period, permanent vesting and disposal of assets.

None of this suggests that the government lacks the authority to strengthen financial oversight or ensure that funds from abroad are used for lawful and proper ends. But in a constitutional order, any regime that reaches into the management of civil society's institutional infrastructure must operate within clear legislative standards.

Ultimately, the constitutional question posed by the FCRA Amendment Bill is not whether foreign contributions should be regulated, but how far the state may go in regulating institutions and their assets. (Thajaswini C.B. is an advocate practising before the Supreme Court, Madras and Delhi High Courts. Siddharth Dev Prasad is a 4th year law student at Gujarat National Law University.)

THE GIST

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. The amendment Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting.

Can jurists be appointed as Supreme Court judges?

Why has the provision allowing distinguished jurists to be appointed as SC judges remained unused?

Aaratrika Bhaumik

The story so far:

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday questioned why a constitutional provision allowing a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed as a judge of the Supreme Court has remained unused for more than 76 years. Addressing the 13th convocation of National Law University, Delhi's LL.M. programme, Justice Bhuyan pointed out that Article 124(3) of the Constitution permits the appointment of a person who, in the President's opinion, is a "distinguished jurist" as a Supreme Court judge. However, no legal academic has so far been elevated to the top court under this provision.

What does the Constitution stipulate?

Article 124(3) of the Constitution lays down three routes through which a

person may qualify for appointment as a Supreme Court judge – a person must have served as a High Court judge for at least five years, practised as an advocate of a High Court for at least 10 years, or be, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist".

The provision, however, does not define who qualifies as a "distinguished jurist" or prescribe any minimum period of professional experience for such a person. Its inclusion as a separate category nevertheless indicates that the framers contemplated a route to the Supreme Court beyond the conventional pathways of judicial service and legal practice, potentially opening the door to eminent legal scholars and academics.

What do Constituent Assembly debates reflect?

The "distinguished jurist" category was added to the list of persons eligible for

appointment to the Supreme Court in the draft Constitution. The Constituent Assembly debates reflect that this was intended to bring diversity in professional backgrounds among those appointed to the Bench of the Supreme Court.

Moving the amendment on May 24, 1949, Constituent Assembly member H.V. Kamath said it sought "to open a wider field of choice" for Supreme Court appointments. He noted that persons with "outstanding legal and juristic learning" were "not necessarily confined to judges or advocates", pointing to the selection of judges of the International Court of Justice on similar terms.

The Constituent Assembly debates also referred to the appointment of Felix Frankfurter to the U.S. Supreme Court. In 1939, President Franklin D. Roosevelt appointed Frankfurter, who had been a professor at Harvard Law School for 25 years, as an Associate Justice of the U.S.

Supreme Court. Justice Frankfurter went on to become a noted advocate of the doctrine of judicial restraint – the principle that courts should respect the domain of the elected legislature and the executive, and exercise restraint in interfering with their decisions.

Assembly member M. Ananthasayanam Ayyangar cited Justice Frankfurter's appointment as a "novel experiment" that had worked well, noting that legal expertise was not confined to practising lawyers or judges.

Can a 'distinguished jurist' be appointed as a High Court judge?

The Constituent Assembly had also considered allowing "distinguished jurists" to be appointed as High Court judges. On June 7, 1949, Professor Shibban Lal Saksena moved an amendment proposing their inclusion among those eligible for appointment to a High Court. The proposal, however, was not accepted.

Nearly three decades later, the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, enacted during the Emergency, amended Article 217, which lays down the qualifications for appointment as a High Court judge. The amendment allowed a person who was, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed to a High Court. The provision came into force in January 1977 but was omitted by the Constitution (Forty-fourth

Amendment) Act, 1978.

What limits the use of this provision?

Despite being part of the Constitution since its inception, the provision has never been invoked. Supreme Court judges have overwhelmingly been appointed from among High Court judges, with only 11 advocates directly elevated from the Bar.

The appointment process itself may also help explain why the provision has remained unused, since a jurist would first have to be recommended by the Supreme Court Collegium. Legal scholar Upendra Baxi, whose possible appointment to the court never materialised, described the provision as a "dead issue" in a 2015 interview with LiveLaw.

Another concern is that legal academics may lack courtroom and procedural experience. However, full-time law teachers themselves face restrictions on practising as advocates. Under Rule 49 of the Bar Council of India Rules, an advocate who takes up full-time salaried employment must cease to practise while such employment continues. In 2019, the Consortium of National Law Universities sought a relaxation of this restriction to allow full-time faculty to practise in courts and bridge the divide between "law in books" and "law in action".

BOOK EXTRACT



Fisherwomen cast a large traditional fishing net into the Indravati river on the outskirts of Jagdalpur in Bastar district, Chhattisgarh. PTI

A colonial gaze: how the British imagined Bastar and its people

Colonial accounts portrayed Bastar as a primitive, isolated woodland whose inhabitants were ‘rude and barbarous,’ while a flawed census produced wildly unreliable population figures and recorded a plethora of colourful yet inaccurate professions

Shantanu Nandan Sharma

For years, Bastar remained an enigma to the British, who erroneously and conveniently dismissed it as a mysterious woodland inhabited by cannibals, painting it as an island of primitiveness amidst civilisations. In his enthusiasm to author a two-volume work on India, East India Company official Henry Harpur Spry went so far as to describe the people of Bastar as those who ‘sacrifice and eat their fellow creatures’.

Spread of misinformation

Consider this: Spry never set foot in Bastar, relying instead on hearsay from Company officers like Captain Crawford of the Bengal Artillery, who oversaw Chhattisgarh. Spry’s armchair account reads more like lengthy chatter rather than a valuable historical document. Further, there is no evidence to suggest that Crawford himself had any first-hand experience in Bastar. It is important to put it on record that Spry also made a glaring mistake on Bastar when he called its Rajput Raja a Gond. This mistake was possibly carried over from the past. While translating the *Tarikh-i-Firishta*, a medieval Persian history of the Deccan with intriguing references to the Bastar of 1610-11, John Briggs added an asterisk to the Bastar raja, mistakenly labelling him as a Gond chief.

The isolation of Bastar fostered the spread of misinformation. A report from the East India Company in 1812, for

example, provided a skewed perspective of the area and the people therein. The inhabitants were described as ‘rude and barbarous’, yet they were paradoxically praised for the staunch defence of their ‘ancient rightful inheritance’ - the lowlands. The report says that they, ‘although rude and barbarous, may yet be denominated warlike, as they have always distinguished themselves bold, persevering champions of the great law of nature’.

It further adds: ‘Being driven to their wild unwholesome fastness, among the mountains, they frequently descend in harvest time, into the lowlands, to dispute the produce of their ancient rightful inheritance with their present possessors...’ Clearly, the report’s author had not visited the territory.

Counting the people

The first attempt to quantify Bastar’s population came on November 5, 1866 during a census in the Central Provinces. This inaugural headcount yielded a figure of 2,69,684. However, the census was plagued by significant anomalies. The administration faced a dilemma when the next census in 1872 showed an inexplicable 70 per cent drop in the population, bringing the total down to 78,856. The breakdown of this figure included 29,060 Hindus, 1,704 Muslims, and a substantial category of 48,092 classified as ‘others’.

A deadly combination of cholera and famine ravaged central India in 1869, undoubtedly impacting Bastar. However,

this alone would not explain the population plunge – a staggering 1,90,828 residents vanishing in just six years. The numbers reeked of error.

J.W. Neill, officiating secretary to the Central Provinces’ chief commissioner, echoed these concerns in his report on the 1872 census. He pointed out glaring inconsistencies: The 1866 Bastar figures were likely mere estimates based on area, while the 1872 census, despite claiming a more rigorous method, also appeared flawed, as in many villages ‘the children were not enumerated’. The report quotes comments from the deputy commissioner of Upper Godavari district, under whose jurisdiction Bastar fell for census purposes.

Neill’s report continued to expose the flaws of the 1872 census in Bastar. While forms and instructions reached the raja, ‘there is no means of knowing whether houses were numbered or lists of inhabitants taken previous to the night of the Census’. Some areas, such as Jagdalpur, Bhopalpatnam and Bijapur, showed decent efforts, but the rest carried errors.

Most alarmingly, children under twelve were entirely omitted. While the Central Provinces overall saw a modest increase (from 9.06 million to 9.25 million), Bastar’s dramatic decline remained an enigma. In the census exercise of early British days, a headcount was conducted on a single day.

The 1872 census wasn’t just plagued by regional discrepancies; there were some structural errors too. The sheer number

of categories (caste, occupation, race, religion, remarks, etc. – a whopping nineteen) gave printers nightmares. Worse yet, a lack of training on open-ended questions led to a plethora of colourful yet inaccurate professions across the Central Provinces. Imagine finding entries like ‘con man’, ‘pimp’, ‘prostitute’, ‘idiot’, and ‘thief’ – a reflection more on the confusion of the enumerators than the reality of the population.

Neill’s report candidly highlighted the hilarious mishaps. He blamed some of the bizarre entries on overzealous enumerators who seemed determined to write something or the other in the occupancy column against every individual. Infants, for instance, were listed as ‘sucking’, children as simply ‘playing’, and newcomers to a village as ‘guests’.

Further confusion arose with the term *pesha-i-khud*, loosely translated as self-employed. Its frequent appearance left senior officers scratching their heads, unsure of the specific occupations it indicated. Neill even documented the enumerators’ struggle to differentiate between lunatics and idiots, wryly noting ‘it having been impossible to separate them, as the enumerators did not appreciate the distinction between the two classes’. (Excerpted with permission from Hachette India from Shantanu Nandan Sharma’s *Rebel Bastar: History, Maoism and the Search for Answers in India’s Heartland*)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the difference between “cousin” and “half brother”? (N. Vardhan, Chennai)

The children of your father’s/ mother’s sister or brother are your “cousins”. In other words, your uncle’s kids or your aunt’s kids are your cousins. For most native speakers of English, cousins are what we in India call “first cousins”. In India, however, we have a tendency to introduce anyone who is distantly related to us as “my cousin”. Native speakers of English do not do this.

A “half brother” is someone who shares the same father or mother as you. In other words, if you have a half brother, it implies that you either have a stepfather or a stepmother.

What is the meaning of “on the qui vive”? (A. Umar, Kadayanallur)

First, let’s deal with the pronunciation. “Qui” is pronounced like the word “key” and “ive” in “vive” sounds like the word “eve”.

When you say that someone is “on the qui vive”, what you are implying is that he/she is alert; he/she is watching very carefully. This is what the expression means in English.

Geetha is always on the qui vive for bargains.

The soldiers were on the qui vive for another assault.

What is the difference between an “escort” and a “convoy”? (P. Parshuram, Secunderabad)

An “escort” is something or someone that is given to an individual as a mark of respect or as a form of protection. For example, Ministers in our country always have bodyguards surrounding them. The bodyguards are their escorts; they go wherever the Minister goes. Similarly, when an actress attends a party, she usually has an escort. When Hema Malini was young, her mother escorted her to most parties.

A “convoy”, on the other hand, refers to the vehicles that accompany someone important. Whenever a Chief Minister goes somewhere, he/she usually has about ten or fifteen cars following him/her. These cars are part of the convoy. Unlike the word “escort”, a convoy is usually used to refer to things (cars, lorries, ships, etc); the word is not used to refer to people.

What is the origin of the term “Molotov cocktail”? (M. R. Hareesh, Taliparamba)

Let me begin by telling you that this “cocktail” is no drink. A “Molotov cocktail” is a homemade firebomb! It usually consists of an inflammable liquid in a bottle to which a wick is attached. The wick is then lit and the bottle is thrown at someone or something. The result? The bottle explodes and the object catches fire. We see a lot of such bombs used by the villains in our regional films.

“Molotov cocktail” is named after V.M. Molotov, the man who was the Foreign Minister of the Soviet Union during World War II. When the Nazis invaded Russia during the Second World War, the Russian civilians used this cocktail quite successfully to destroy the German tanks. *Published in The Hindu on November 11, 2001*

THE DAILY QUIZ

A look at Lionel Messi’s international career in the wake of the Argentine football legend’s retirement

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1

In which year and where did Lionel Messi win the Olympic Gold and the Under-20 World Cup?

QUESTION 2

How many goals and assists did Messi net in his 207-match career for ‘La Albiceleste’?

QUESTION 3

Messi had a senior international debut to forget on August 17, 2005, because he was shown a straight red card, less than a minute after coming on in the 63rd minute, for an accidental elbow to an opponent.

Against which European team did this happen?

QUESTION 4

Which final heartbreak prompted Messi’s first international retirement in June 2016?

QUESTION 5

Messi holds the record for most major tournament goals in men’s history with how many goals?

QUESTION 6

With whom does Messi share the record for FIFA World Cup appearances (six in total)?

QUESTION 7

Against which South American country has he netted the most international goals (11)?



Visual question: In this image, Messi is celebrating the triumph in which tournament? REUTERS

Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz:

1. This British constitutional initiative provided the framework for the formation of the Interim Government. **Ans: The Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946**
 2. The Commander-in-Chief of India while the Interim govt. was in operation. **Ans: General Sir Claude Auchinleck**
 3. The Muslim League finally joined the Interim Government on this date. **Ans: October 26, 1946**
 4. The members of the Constituent Assembly, from which the Interim Government was formed were chosen through this mechanism. **Ans: They were not elected directly by the public. Members were elected by the provincial legislative assemblies**
 5. The Interim Government ceased to exist on this date. Mention the major constitutional event which brought its tenure to an end. **Ans: It ceased to exist on August 15, 1947, when British India was partitioned and power was transferred to the new Dominions of India and Pakistan**
- Visual: Identify these members of the Interim Government. **Ans: (From left) Sarat Chandra Bose, Jagjivan Ram, Rajendra Prasad, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Asaf Ali, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru and Syed Ali Zaheer**
Early birds: Prem Nath Tiwari| Sitaram Saharay| Neil Lall| Anan E A Rahim| Venkat Parthasarathy

Please send in your answers to
dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Word of the day

Excoriate:

express strong disapproval of

Synonyms: condemn, reprobate, decry

Usage: *The activists excoriated the violence against minority communities.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/excoriate

International Phonetic Alphabet: /ɪkˈskɔː.ɪ.ɛt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

CBI should probe ‘cash for transfer’ scam in Punjab: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Wednesday demanded the resignation of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and a Central Bureau of Investigation probe into the “cash for transfer” charges in the State.

There were serious allegations of institutional corruption in Punjab, BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said. Citing the purported findings of a probe by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), he alleged that money was being taken for the transfers and postings of senior bureaucrats and police officers.

Confidential government documents had reached middlemen, but despite seven letters from the ED, no FIR had been registered, the BJP leader said. He demanded the immediate resignation of Mr. Mann and a fair investigation by the CBI.

Claiming that Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal and Mr. Mann “have today become symbols of corruption”, Mr. Bhatia alleged that senior Punjab officials were involved in the “scam”. “Their transfers and postings are carried



Gaurav Bhatia

out according to a rate card...This rate card fixes the price for who will get which charge and in which department they will be posted,” he said.

The facts presented by the ED before the Punjab and Haryana High Court in its affidavit revealed that confidential documents, draft lists of postings and transfers, and draft lists of government policies to be implemented in the future were found on WhatsApp on the mobile phones of alleged middlemen and touts, Mr. Bhatia said.

“The concerning aspect is that, in accordance with the law, the ED told the Punjab Police that this was a cognisable offence and that an FIR should be registered. However, despite seven letters being written to the Punjab Police, no FIR was registered,” he said.

Air Force veteran appointed first Ram Temple Trust CEO

Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) served in IAF for 31 years; Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, Nirmala Yadav named trustees; move comes amid allegation of donation theft

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday appointed Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) as its first chief executive officer.

The appointment came at a time when the Trust is strengthening its administrative structure amid allegations of theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

The appointment was announced after a meeting of the Trust at the Maniram Das Chawani in Ayodhya, where the trustees also filled three vacant positions on the Board.

The vacancies arose following the resignations of senior Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader and general secretary Champat Rai, and trustee Anil Mishra. They quit in July after the embezzlement allegations surfaced.

The third vacancy arose after the death of trustee Vimlendra Pratap Mishra, a member of Ayodhya's erstwhile royal family.

According to a commu-



Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) was awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Medal and was also a part of Operation Sindoor. PTI

nique issued by the Trust, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra was appointed following the recommendations of a committee constituted to select the CEO.

The process involved scrutinising about 5,585 applications, and interviewing hundreds of candidates over a period of nearly two months.

Air Vice-Marshal Mishra served in the Indian Air Force for 31 years, holding positions across different departments and gaining extensive leadership experience, the Trust said.

It added that the new CEO was also awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Me-

dal, one of the highest military decorations for distinguished service in wartime. He was also part of Operation Sindoor.

‘Unaware of selection’

He had not been aware of his selection prior to the announcement made to the media on Wednesday, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra told *The Hindu*.

“I also got to know about my selection through television. I am elated,” he said.

The trustees also appointed three new members – Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, and Nirmala Yadav – to fill

the vacant positions. Mr. Bhagchandka is associated with Ashok Singhla Foundation, while Mr. Pandey is an advocate.

Ms. Yadav will be the first woman to hold a trusteeship in the Trust.

Swami Govind Dev Giri will continue as the Trust's general secretary, while Mr. Bhagchandka will take charge as treasurer. The Trust's annual accounts for 2025-26 have also been approved.

Financial details

The Trust recorded a total income of about ₹237 crore, and expenditure of about ₹99 crore during the financial year. It also incurred about ₹425 crore in capital expenditure on construction and related works. As of March 31, the Trust had total funds of about ₹1,882 crore.

The VHP hailed the appointment of the CEO. VHP president Alok Kumar described Air Vice-Marshal Mishra as a senior and respected personality, adding that his extensive experience would help the Trust function more effectively and transparently.

Cong. cites Garg's analysis to question GDP growth figures

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government under Modi between 2017 and 2019

PAWAN KHERA
Congress leader

The Congress on Wednesday stepped up its attack on the Union government over the latest GDP figures, citing reported remarks by former Finance Secretary Subhash Chandra Garg to argue that the Centre was using statistical revisions to present an inflated picture of economic growth.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh shared a video clip of Mr. Garg, who said that revisions to the previous year's GDP had affected comparisons with the current year's figures.

According to Mr. Garg, without the revision, growth at current prices in the April-June quarter would have been around 2.6%, instead of the higher figure being projected.

Mr. Ramesh said the government's claims of robust economic growth, amplified through what he described as statistical “jugglery”, were at odds with conditions on the ground.

‘Burst the bubble’

“Former Finance Secretary Subhash Garg has now burst the bubble on this claim. His assessment is that the real GDP growth is around 2.6%, not 7.8%,” Mr. Ramesh said in a post on social media platform X. “The Modi government must understand: PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself,” he said.

The Congress leader said the government needed to acknowledge the actual state of the economy and undertake reforms to

generate employment, strengthen MSMEs and private investment, raise demand and incomes, reduce inequality and ensure fair competition instead of promoting “crony capitalists”.

Mr. Ramesh said it was significant that questions were being raised over the GDP figures by a former Finance Secretary who had served in the Modi government.

Congress media and publicity department chairman Pawan Khera said Mr. Garg's assessment appeared closer to the “lived reality” of ordinary Indians, marked by rising prices, weakening purchasing power, shrinking disposable incomes and savings, stagnant employment opportunities and increasing household debt.

Seeks explanation

“These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government of India under Modi between 2017 and 2019,” Mr. Khera said, demanding an explanation for the revision of the previous year's GDP figures.

Provide security to rural communities before a crisis strikes, says Cong. chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday said rural communities should not be remembered only during droughts, floods, crop failures or elections, and called for a development model that provides them security before a crisis strikes.

He was speaking at an event organised by the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Foundation and the Dr. KVP Foundation, where the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF) was conferred the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award, 2026.

Mr. Kharge said governments must ensure that farmers have fair markets, rural families have decent livelihoods, and women have economic indepen-



Big honour: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge with Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

dence, while tribal communities and villages need access to technology, opportunities and basic infrastructure. “The government has an important role in creating this security, so that the communities become partners in India's development,” he said.

The Congress president also took a swipe at the

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh. Without naming anyone, he said he had heard an RSS leader claim that India had witnessed many reforms. Mr. Kharge said it was the Congress that had carried out the reforms being referred to.

Linking the award to the legacies of Rajasekhara Reddy and agricultural

scientist M.S. Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge said both believed that development must ultimately serve the dignity of ordinary people.

Rajasekhara Reddy, he said, had worked for the poor and marginalised, while Swaminathan had sought to combine scientific advancement with social equity and environmental sustainability.

Paying tribute to Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge recalled his contribution to the Green Revolution and recalled how the late scientists had described Indira Gandhi as the “most successful warrior against hunger”.

In a video message, Soumya Swaminathan, chair of the MSSRF and daughter of M.S. Swaminathan thanked the organisers for conferring the award on the foundation.

Kapil Sibal seeks SC intervention over ‘bulk SIR deletions’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal on Wednesday urged the Supreme Court to stop the “bulk deletions” taking place under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Mr. Sibal alleged that the ongoing SIR was aimed at helping the BJP win elections. In a post on X, he termed it “politics of exclusion”, and alleged that “BJP agents” were looking to “target Muslims, seek bulk deletions”. He added, “Supreme Court needs to stop this!”

Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Sibal cited a report from Jharkhand, alleging that the form to request the deletion of names from the voters' list was being filed in bulk by BJP workers.

He said, “You can file bulk forms – you can take

45 of them, or 100 of them, or even 400 of them. You can file the forms, and you can say that this name should be deleted. You don't have to give any reason for it, and if it is found to be false, it doesn't matter.”

Earlier, *The Hindu* had reported that cases of Form 7 being submitted in bulk had surfaced in States like Rajasthan, Gujarat and Assam.

‘Serious issue’

Mr. Sibal alleged that many people whose names were sought to be deleted were Muslims and had been living in their area for years.

“Therefore, this is a very serious issue, and if courts don't take care of this issue, if courts just believe that the SIR exercise is by a neutral EC, then I think we are in deep trouble; this democracy will be in deep trouble,” he said.

Former AIMIM leader joins Congress ahead of 2027 U.P. election

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Syed Asim Waqar, former spokesperson of the All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM), joined the Congress on Wednesday, alleging that the Asaduddin Owaisi-led party paid lip service to the objective of defeating the Bharatiya Janata Party while fighting the Opposition parties on the ground.

Mr. Waqar joined the Congress at the party headquarters here in the presence of All India Congress Committee (AICC) in-charge for Uttar Pradesh Rajendra Pal Gautam, State Congress president Ajay Rai and AICC Minority Department chairman Imran Pratapgarhi.

Explaining his decision, Mr. Waqar said his years in the AIMIM had convinced him that a party seeking to remove the BJP from pow-



Syed Asim Waqar

er could not simultaneously weaken those fighting the ruling party. “If we keep fighting the Opposition and do not allow it to grow, then we are helping the BJP,” Mr. Waqar said.

Mr. Rai said Mr. Waqar's induction would strengthen the party in Uttar Pradesh ahead of the 2027 Assembly election. A key AIMIM voice in Uttar Pradesh and considered close to Mr. Owaisi, Mr. Waqar's exit comes as the AIMIM seeks to expand its political footprint in the State.

Rahul takes stock of Maharashtra issues

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday sought a detailed assessment of key political issues in Maharashtra, including the deletion of names from the electoral rolls, Maratha and OBC reservation issues and tribal protests.

He is in Nashik for the

party's ‘Sanghatan Srujan Abhiyan’.

Later, Mr. Gandhi interacted with the families of the district Congress committee presidents before addressing the concluding session of the training camp. He urged the district presidents to expand the organisation and take the Congress's ideology to people across the State.

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2662/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001567) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
"Establishment of 220/33kV Murmi (Dahegaon Bangla) S/S along with construction of LILo on existing 220kV Waluj Chitegaon SC line (RL-12.99km) at 220kV Murmi Substation, Tal. Gangapur, Dist. Ch. Sambhajinagar under Ch. Sambhajinagar Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra."
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **31.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

**BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION**
Office of the Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, Thimmaiah Road, Queens Road, Bangalore

Tender NO. EE/SJN/E-PROC/27/2026-27
Date: 02.09.2026

**INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(TWO COVER SYSTEM)**
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Executive Engineer (Shivaji Nagar Division), BCCC, Bangalore invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered in CPWD / KPWD / Railways /MES/ National Highway or any State Government Organizations for the construction of work detailed in the table below.
Standard Tender Document KW4.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Heritage restoration, Reconstruction & development of Russel Market in Shivajinagara in Bengaluru City Amount Put to Tender : Rs.7,000.00 Lakhs. EMD : Rs.70,00,000.00.

Calendar of Events : (1) Tenders must be submitted online through e-procurement portal on or before **16.00 hours on 03.10.2026** and the opening of tenders will be as per the e-procurement portal guidelines. (2) Pre bid meeting will be held on **24.09.2026 at 15.00** in the office of the Chief Engineer Zone-2, Bengaluru City Central Palike, Annexure-3, 4th Floor, GBA office compound, N R Square, Bengaluru (3) Last Date for uploading the Filled Tender Document is **03.10.2026 upto 16.00pm**. (4) Date of Technical bid opening of Tenders is on **05.10.2026 by 11.00 am** (5) Date of Financial bid Opening of Tenders is on after Technical bid approved.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, BCCC

**Maharashtra State Agricultural Marketing Board,Pune (MSAMB)**

E-Tender Notice

MSAMB invites e-Tender for Construction of a Modern Primary Processing Center for Orange at Agricultural Produce Market Committee, Katol (Sub Market Khangoan), Taluka - Katol, Dist.Nagpur. Estimated cost of said work is Rs.625.23 Lakhs (GST extra). For details, please visit www.msamb.com and <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.
Managing Director

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2671/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001585) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
"Establishment of 110/22kV Gaikwadpada GIS substation, Dist. Thane with associated lines using 220kV equipments and UG cable on turnkey basis under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra."
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खण्ड घाटोल
जिला बांसवाड़ा (राज.)
क्रमांक :- 515
दिनांक :- 18/08/2026

निविदा संशोधन
निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27
NIB CODE:- PWD262742362

इस खण्ड कार्यालय के पत्रांक 499 दिनांक 14.08.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27 में दलित कार्य संख्या 1 एवं 4 में विधिल कार्य हेतु अनुमानित लागत राशि एवं श्रोह रशि में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है :-

कार्य क्रम संख्या	पूर्व निर्धारित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	पूर्व निर्धारित श्रोह रशि (लाखों में)	संशोधित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	संशोधित श्रोह रशि (लाखों में)
1	42.50	8500	42.52	8504
2	32.66	65320	38.54	77080

नोट- निविदा की शेष शर्तें मूल निविदा सूचना अनुसार रहेंगी।
(सोपान विवरण)
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खंड घाटोल
DIPRC/15544/2026

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2681/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001579) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
"Work of (A) Establishment of 400/220kV Kalwa GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines & (B) Establishment of 400/220kV Padghe Split GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra."
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

A BM-BME



Bengaluru-based EV manufacturer Simple Energy on Wednesday unveiled Simple Wave, a new range of electric scooters aimed at family buyers. The range comprises three variants and is available in six colours – Pearl White, Coral Red, Twilight Black, Polar Blue, Dolphin Grey and Forest Green. The company claims the scooters offer an IDC range of up to 243 km and storage capacity of up to 70 litres. Prices start at ₹1,09,999 (ex-showroom).

Danish biosolutions company Novonosis has announced an investment of ₹6,660 crore (€600 million) to expand its facility at Patalganga in Maharashtra and establish an advanced enzyme production facility. The expansion is aimed at increasing the company's production capacity to meet growing global demand for biosolutions. The new facility, which is expected to be fully operational by 2030, will manufacture enzymes for a range of industries, including biofuels.

Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra on Wednesday opposed the formation of a five-member bench by the NCLT to decide his personal insolvency case, contending that the tribunal does not have the power to constitute such a bench. Appearing for Mr. Chandra before the appellate tribunal NCLAT, Senior Advocate Sasmit Patra termed the NCLT order “faulty and wrong” and said, “they are not empowered” to form a five-member bench. PTI

M. Soundariya Preetha
COIMBATORE

Textile mills are witnessing a revival in cotton-yarn demand with capacity utilisation crossing 90% but a sharp rise in cotton prices is raising concerns over operational sustainability.

“Cotton yarn demand started reviving almost five months ago and now, mills are not holding much yarn stocks,” said Durai Palanisamy, chairman, Southern India Mills Association.

Cotton prices had risen sharply since mid-March, with local prices moving in line with ICE Futures, he said, adding mills had relatively low inventories with most maintaining less than two months stock.

Cotton prices which ranged between ₹51,700-₹57,000 a candy between October last and end March 2026 surged to ₹70,000/candy on September 2 on an ex-gin basis.

“Factors such as higher demand from China and likely lower output from the U.S. and China are pushing up prices,” said Nishant Asher, secretary, Indian Cotton Federation.

"Our cotton yarn cannot be used fully by local apparel sector. Textile mills need global opportunities for viable operations. Yarn prices adjust to cotton prices. Globally, too, yarn availability is under pressure, boosting prices," said Ravi Sam, vice-chairman, Cotton Textile Export Promotion Council.

Sources said Indian cotton prices were lower than global prices. The Cotton Corporation of India, which procured huge quantities of cotton at minimum support price, must stabilise prices.

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Consultations are on for introducing a new tender for wind offshore technology in Tamil Nadu, Rajesh Kulkari, Joint Secretary, Union Renewable Ministry told reporters here.

Mr. Kulhari said feasibility studies conducted in the State had yielded positive results.

"All [feasibility] studies have been completed in Tamil Nadu. The good news is capacity utilisation factor is more than 50%," he stated, adding, "collection of required data for offshore wind off the coast of Tamil Nadu, that is, wind velocity, geo-technical and geo-physical – have been completed by the National Institute of Wind Energy (NIWE)."

Sanjana B
BENGALURU

Almost a quarter of PayPal's about 6,700 India staff have either been laid off or are in the process of being laid off, sources said.

A PayPal spokesperson said, "The recent staffing changes are part of previously announced multi-year transformation to simplify global operations, strengthen execution and position the firm for long-term growth. We are committed to supporting staff through this transition."

In May, media reports

Reuters
NEW DELHI

VinFast suspended plans to make three electric vehicles in India and ordered suppliers to halt work on the projects while it reviews costs, as per sources and a memo reviewed by *Reuters* – a year after Vietnam's automaker entered the crucial growth market.

VinFast asked suppliers to “hold all activities” on three programmes, including a two-door SUV called VF 3 – expected to be its most competitive model in the market – and VF 6 and VF 7 SUVs, which it imports from Vietnam and assembles in the country.

The suspension marks another setback for loss-making VinFast which turned to India after difficulties in gaining market shares in U.S. and Europe.



Cushioning impact: The RBI has already begun absorbing rupee liquidity to ensure call rates did not fall below policy rate. REUTERS

The RBI had introduced a special USD-INR forex swap facility covering these instruments on June 8 this year to deal with forex outflows due to high oil prices and flight of capital owing to exit of Foreign

Portfolio Investors (FOIs)
from the stock market.

The central bank may prioritise closing its \$137 billion short forward dollar positions with the FCNR (B) deposits received, according to experts and in-

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Japan Credit Rating Agency (JCR) has upgraded India's credit rating by one notch from BBB+ to 'A-', as announced on Wednesday, on the back of India's relatively high growth, the government's growth-oriented policies, and the improved strength of the financial system.

FinMin welcomes

The Ministry of Finance has issued a statement welcoming the development,

saying that this comes against the backdrop of a challenging global environment.

A higher rating means that India can borrow at lower costs in the future, leading to a lower interest burden on the exchequer.

“The Indian economy has maintained a high

growth rate of around 7%, supported by robust private consumption and public investment,” JCR said in its rationale for the ratings upgrade. “The government of India has steadily implemented policies conducive to productivity growth and economic development, including the development of digital public infrastructure and the implementation of the goods and services tax (GST), strengthening the country’s economic foundations as compared to the past,” it added.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Quebec-based La Caisse pension fund announced on Wednesday that it was acquiring a 24% stake in Altius Telecom Infrastructure Trust, India's largest trust through which tower and other telecom infrastructure spending is directed. The acquisition entails a CA\$1.76 billion investment, or ₹12,100 crore.

Canadian investment management MNC Brookfield remains the SEBI-registered Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT)'s largest shareholder.

‘Reflective of demand’

In a statement alongside Brookfield, La Caisse said that its acquisition “reflects growing demand for mobile connectivity and 5G infrastructure in India”.

The pension fund added, “India is the world’s second-largest telecommunications market, and continued growth in mobile data use and 5G is increasing the need for digital infrastructure.”

While two of the three private telecom operators have spread their 5G networks throughout every district in India in record time, infrastructure spending is expected to grow as many sites are not directly connected through fiber optic cables, and more sites need to be added to expand coverage in semi-urban and rural areas to meet growing traffic demand by users.



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HONG KONG

Hong Kong activist Joshua Wong pleads guilty to ‘foreign collusion’



Prominent Hong Kong pro-democracy activist Joshua Wong pleaded guilty on Wednesday to conspiracy to collude with foreign forces to endanger national security under a Beijing-imposed law. It was the second prosecution of Mr. Wong, a former student leader in the pro-democracy movement. AP

ISTANBUL

‘Mechanism needed for Black Sea safety before grain crisis escalates’



Turkiye’s President Tayyip Erdogan said on Wednesday a mechanism is needed to permanently ensure the safety of commercial maritime transport in the Black Sea before a grain crisis escalates. “The safety of all civilian maritime transportation in the Black Sea is important to us,” Mr. Erdogan said. REUTERS

KYIV

11 injured in Kyiv as Russian attacks continue for seventh straight day



Russian drones tore into central Kyiv on Wednesday morning, wounding 11 people and damaging residential and university buildings on the seventh day of nearly round-the-clock attacks. Russian President Vladimir Putin said he had ordered his forces to prepare the new campaign of “massive” strikes. REUTERS

BUNIA

Congo’s Ebola outbreak shows no signs of slowing; deaths top 3,000



Congo’s Ebola outbreak has killed more than 3,000 people out of over 6,100 cases, the government data showed on Wednesday, as the disease is spreading at an unprecedented speed, faster than efforts to slow it. It was declared a global health emergency in May and remains the fastest-growing outbreak of Ebola ever. AP

Iran fires on its Gulf neighbours in retaliation for renewed U.S. strikes

Tehran says four members of Revolutionary Guard and 10 of the Basij forces killed in U.S. attacks; Israel’s Defence Minister warns of ‘strong independent response’ if attacked; U.S. President suggests Strait of Hormuz be renamed ‘Trump Strait’

Associated Press
DUBAI

Iran fired on U.S. allies in the Gulf early Wednesday following a night of American bombardment that Iranian officials say included a deadly strike on a wedding party. Fighting has escalated since the American military hit Iranian rocket launchers on an island in the Strait of Hormuz over the weekend. Iran retaliated by firing missiles at American bases in Jordan that were intercepted. Kuwait and Bahrain said they had also come under attack, without reporting any casualties.



The aftermath of a U.S. strike on a wedding ceremony in southern Sirik county in Hormozgan province in Iran on Wednesday. AFP

“You will soon see that Iran’s new strategy on the battlefield, in diplomacy, and in confronting the economic blockade will shatter your foundations,” the recently appointed head of Iran’s powerful Supreme National Security Council, Mohsen Rezaei, said on X. Separately, Iran has said four members of its para-

military Revolutionary Guard and 10 members of the Guard’s volunteer Basij forces died in the U.S. attacks. In Iraq, where Iranian-backed forces are active, Kurdish authorities said they had intercepted 10 drones laden with explosives in the Erbil area. Iranian television reported that American bases in Erbil had been targeted. Israel’s military also said that Iran-backed Hezbollah fired two explosive drones at its soldiers in southern Lebanon, without causing casualties. Israel’s Defence Minister Israel Katz said on Wednesday his country was pre-

pared to “respond with great force, independently of anyone else” if attacked by Iran, adding “our planes are ready to take off”. “Trump Strait” U.S. President Donald Trump on Wednesday suggested renaming the Strait of Hormuz as “Trump Strait” despite the fact that the crucial waterway remains contested. “Now that we have it under U.S.A. control, should we change the name Hormuz Strait to TRUMP STRAIT??? Like America itself, it would be ‘hotter’ than ever before!” Mr. Trump said on his Truth Social network.

Hopes of finding survivors dim week after Nepal flood

Reuters
KATHMANDU

Hopes of finding more survivors among the thousands still missing in Nepal were fading, authorities said on Wednesday, a week after a glacier collapse in the Himalayas unleashed flash floods that devastated the mountainous nation. At least 1,114 people have been killed and nearly 4,000 remain unaccounted for, with officials fearing many are buried under debris left by the floods that tore through towns and valleys near the Chinese border. Across the border in Tibet, China’s official toll has held steady since Sunday at 16 dead and 546 missing. “The hope of finding survivors is decreasing,” Phanindra Paudel, a senior official at the government’s National Emergency Operation Centre (NEOC), said.



Nepalese soldiers work during a relief operation outside a tunnel near the hydropower project sites in Rasuwa district. REUTERS

“We pray and are hopeful. Hope is hope!” Rescuers are trying to find survivors believed to be trapped inside the tunnels of several hydroelectric plants, whose powerhouses have spaces and rooms for people to stay, Army spokesperson Raja Ram Basnet said. Authorities said 279 people had been rescued from the ruins of hydropower projects but at least 639 more were still missing, some of whom are believed to be trapped in tunnels. Prime Minister Balendra Shah said the focus would shift from search, rescue and relief operations towards rehabilitation and reconstruction. UN spokesperson Stephane Dujarric said aid agencies were “very concerned” about the growing public health risk.

U.S.-Sri Lanka operation busts drug network

Press Trust of India
COLOMBO

A joint operation by Sri Lankan and U.S. authorities busted a Pakistan-based narco-trafficking network allegedly attempting to smuggle drugs valued at \$21 million. Acting on intelligence about suspicious maritime containers being shipped from Pakistan to Colombo, the joint team seized the crystal methamphetamine concealed in bath towels, a U.S. Embassy release said.

Taliban defend ban on protests, saying it ‘does not exist in Islamic law system’

Agence France-Presse
KABUL

The Taliban defended on Wednesday its ban on protests that has drawn condemnation from rights groups, saying the order complies with Islamic law. Demonstrations in Afghanistan have been rare since the Taliban returned to power just over five years ago, but the government last month introduced a rule holding that “all types of protests are banned”. International organisations have decried the law



as “ruthless” and a move to suppress any dissent in the country. Taliban regime spokesperson Zabihullah Mujahid said during a news conference that the “law fully

complies with Islamic law”, adding that “protests don’t exist in Islamic law”. “Protests belong to societies where there are different laws established, for example a democracy or a republic,” he said. Under the Islamic system, he said, people can approach the government with concerns rather than hold demonstrations. Mr. Mujahid argued the ban “will also protect people from wasting time” and prevent the destruction of private property. Human Rights Watch late last month slammed the ban as “another step in the Taliban’s ruthless effort to suppress all dissent”. Amnesty International described the Taliban’s broader series of changes to law enforcement as “another sweeping assault on human rights in Afghanistan”, calling the protest ban “among its most egregious provisions”. While demonstrations are rare, at least two persons were killed in June when security forces reportedly opened fire on a women’s rights protest in the western city of Herat, a group of UN experts said.

BENGALURU CO-OP. MILK UNION LTD., [BENGALURU DAIRY]
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E-mail Address : bamulpurchase@gmail.com
Website: www.bamulnandini.coop Phone:080-26096214 & 282

Tender Ref No: BAMUL/PUR/09/1853/T-359/2026-27

Date: 02.09.2026

SHORT-TERM TECHNICAL CUM COMMERCIAL TENDER THROUGH KARNATAKA PUBLIC PROCUREMENT PORTAL

Bengaluru Co-op Milk Union Ltd., (BAMUL) Bengaluru, invites e-tender through e-Procurement Portal from the interested and eligible Manufacturers/Contractor/Dealer/Distributors for Supply of the following item.

Sl. No.	Particulars	Qty	Estd Cost in Lakhs	Tender No
01	Design Supply Installation Testing And Commissioning Of Plastic Blown Pouch Film Plant at Bengaluru Dairy.	01 Lot (Lumpsum)	2200.00	KMF/2026-27/IND2324/Call-3
1	Access to E-tender Documents	03.09.2026 to 10.09.2026 till 02.00 PM		
2	Pre-Bid Meeting /Tender clarification date & time	05.09.2026 till 11.00 AM		
3	Last date for submission of tender/ quoting	10.09.2026 till 02.00 PM		
4	Date & time for opening Technical Tender	11.09.2026 at 02.05 PM		
5	Date & time for opening Commercial Tender	15.09.2026 at 11.00 AM		
6	Place of opening of Technical and Commercial Tender	BAMUL (Bengaluru Dairy) Board Room		

The Tenderers shall submit separate tender for the above, Tenderers are advised to note the qualification criteria specified in Section VII to qualify for award of the contract.

The Earnest money deposit (E.M.D.) valid for 45 days beyond the validity of the tender i.e. total for 135 days, Tender processing Fee, modes of e-payment, tender document details and other details are mentioned in <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> and also contact Help line No: 8046010000/8068948777

Sd/- Managing Director
Tender Inviting Authority, Bamul

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
KANUPUR IRRIGATION PROJECT
AT/PO-BASUDEVPUR, DIST-KEONJHAR, ODISHA, PIN-758047
e-mail: ccekippur@gmail.com

"e"- PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Bid Identification No.: CCE, KIP (KRCaBD)-09/2026-27

(Pertaining to Kanpur Rehabilitation Campus & Building Division, Basudevpur)

1. Name of the Work	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
2. Total No. of Package	05 (Five Nos. of individual Work)
3. Estimated Cost	559.90 to 690.56 Lakh
4. Period of completion	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
5. Class of Contractor	"A" or "Special" Class Contractor as per Detailed Tender Call Notice
6. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Dt.03.09.2026 from 10.00 Hours to Dt.18.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
7. Last date / Time for receipt of bids in the portal	18.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
8. Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Technical Bid)	19.09.2026 at 11.00 Hours
9. Name and address of the Officer Inviting Bid	Er. Mahendra Kumar Behera Chief Construction Engineer, Kanupur Irrigation Project, At/Po.- Basudevpur, Dist.-Keonjhar, Odisha - 758047.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal "<https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in>"

(Er.Mahendra Kumar Behera)
Chief Construction Engineer,
Kanupur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Keonjhar, Odisha

32001/781/2627

OIPR-32001/32376/1/26-27/0006

ODISHA
NEW OPPORTUNITIES

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL),
IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST-22/2026-27 : TCN No.25282, dt.25/08/2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Block Level Stadium (with Indoor Hall), in Kukudakhandi Block under Ganjam District.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.15.42 Crore

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :

- Start Date : 18.00 Hours of dt.08.09.2026
- End Date : 15.00 Hours of dt.23.09.2026
- Opening date : 16.00 Hours of dt.23.09.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in, Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar

4001/293/2627

OIPR-4001/40751/1/26-27/0103

Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB)
Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Paryatan Bhawan, Near O.N.G.C. Helipad, Nimbuwala, Garhi Cantt, Dehradun - 248003 (UK)
Ph. 0135-2559898, Fax 135-2559888

Ref. No. 3230/2-7-1020/2026-27

Dated: 02 September, 2026

UTDB invites tender for Supply of Ski Equipment to the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB), Dehradun, Uttarakhand

Details may be obtained on website: uktenders.gov.in and uttarakhandtourism.gov.in from 3:00 PM on 03.09.2026. Prospective Bidders may seek clarification till 03:00 PM on 08.09.2026 through E-mail: adventurewingutdb@gmail.com with CC to procurement.utdb@gmail.com. Any Addendum/Corrigendum including date extension will be uploaded only on uktenders.gov.in. Bids must be submitted online through uktenders.gov.in only. The last date for submission of bids is 26.09.2026 till 15:00 PM.

Chief Executive Officer

Sport

EALA MANIA

‘We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people’



Alex Eala’s fans arrived in huge numbers when she trained and then played in her first round US Open match. One of them was Andrea Belen, who FaceTimed with her father during the session so he could see Eala. “Everyone went crazy. We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people,” said Belen.

DOUBLY SWEET

To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special: Monfils



Gael Monfils stood in the middle of the court and bowed to the crowd that treated the Frenchman to a roaring ovation on his 40th birthday. “To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special. You guys made it incredible,” said Monfils to the fans at the Louis Armstrong Stadium, who sang happy birthday to him.

SHOWTIME

Frodin, Serena’s body double in King Richard, hogs the limelight



Thea Frodin once had to hit like Serena Williams in the King Richard movie in 2021. On Tuesday at the US Open, the 17-year-old showed some pretty good power of her own in real life. “Being aggressive has always been my game. Hopefully, the next time I meet her [Rybakina], I will see what I can do,” said Frodin.

IN THE HOTSEAT

Red Bull’s Lawson to race in Italian GP as injury keeps Hadjar out



Liam Lawson will remain Max Verstappen’s teammate at Red Bull for the Italian GP after Isack Hadjar failed to recover in time from his wrist injury, the team confirmed. Hadjar had said he was hopeful of returning for Sunday’s race but will now miss a second event. Yuki Tsunoda gets a second race with Racing Bulls in Lawson’s seat.

Zverev battles back from the brink to subdue Sonogo

The top-seeded German was two points from defeat in the fourth set; French Open runner-up Cobolli also wins five-set marathon; Rybakina and Gauff move up with ease on rain-affected day

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Top-seeded Alexander Zverev survived a scare, overcoming Lorenzo Sonogo in a wild-five setter at the US Open on Tuesday as Elena Rybakina and Coco Gauff advanced with ease. Zverev fought off a determined challenge from Italy’s lowly ranked Sonogo, winning 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4 in a tense all-court battle spiced by unlikely retrievals, impossibly angled winners and some inexplicable errors, which wrapped up on Arthur Ashe Stadium after four hours and 53 minutes at 1:55 in the morning.



Finding his range: Zverev conjured up unlikely retrievals and hit impossibly angled winners. REUTERS

Incredible “I’m just happy I won, that’s it. Incredible battle,” said Zverev, who was two points from defeat trailing 5-4 in the fourth set. The German held serve and broke Sonogo in the next game, then earned the lone break of the fifth set to complete the win. Fifth-seeded Flavio Cobolli, runner-up to Zverev at Roland Garros, rallied to beat Argentina’s Francisco Comesana 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4. Nerves didn’t seem to be a problem for ninth-seeded Taylor Fritz as he sailed past fellow American Darwin Blanch 6-3, 6-2, 6-4. There was no such drama for women’s World No. 2 Rybakina and former champion Gauff. Rybakina, eyeing a third Grand Slam

IMPORTANT RESULTS

First round: Men: 1-Zverev (Ger) bt Sonogo (Ita) 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4; 13-Musetti (Ita) bt Fery (GBR) 6-3, 6-3, 7-5; 9-Fritz (USA) bt Blanch (USA) 6-3, 6-2, 6-4; 24-Cerundolo (Arg) bt Misolic (Aut) 6-4, 6-3, 7-5; 5-Cobolli (Ita) bt Comesana (Arg) 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4.

Women: 5-Andreeva bt Tjen (Ina) 6-2, 6-2; 24-Potapova (Aut) bt Semenistaja (Lat) 6-2, 6-2; 4-Gauff

(USA) bt Sonmez (Tur) 6-3, 6-4; 22-Keys (USA) bt Korneeva 7-5, 6-4; 17-Eala (Phi) bt Stoiana (USA) 6-1, 6-2; Putintseva (Kaz) bt 12-Bencic (Sui) 4-6, 7-5, 6-3; 23-Mertens (Bel) bt Quevedo (Esp) 6-4, 6-4; 32-Sakkari (Gre) bt Montgomery (USA) 2-6, 7-5, 6-2; 2-Rybakina (Kaz) bt Frodin (USA) 6-3, 6-2.

Fallen seed: Women: 12-Bencic.

Women’s French Open champion Mirra Andreeva also advanced easily, cruising past Indonesia’s 36th-ranked Janice Tjen 6-2, 6-2. Keys, a former Australian Open winner who lost in the first round at Flushing Meadows last year, conquered first-match jitters to beat 19-year-old Russian Alina Korneeva 7-5, 6-4. While play went as scheduled on the covered Ashe and Armstrong stadiums, those on outside courts – including Rybakina – had to wait out some lengthy rain delays.

Delays That included a near four-hour delay to the start of play and more delays in the evening. Five late matches were postponed altogether and a handful of others suspended.

Stakeholders to meet today to chart India’s roadmap till ODI World Cup

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) will convene a critical stock-taking meeting of key stakeholders of India’s men’s cricket teams at its headquarters here on Thursday. It is understood that the meeting will seek to take a deep dive into the issues that have affected India’s performances of late and chart a roadmap through to next year’s ODI World Cup, including a possible extension of chief selector Ajit Agarkar’s tenure. Multiple sources in the BCCI have confirmed that head coach Gautam Gambhir, Agarkar, Centre of Excellence head of cricket V.V.S. Laxman, captains Shubman Gill and Shreyas



Agarkar’s extension as chief selector will be discussed. FILE PHOTO: EMMANUEL YOGINI

Iyer, and BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia will attend the meeting in person. Two key BCCI executives are also expected to be present, while some other office-bearers may join via videoconference. Having taken charge in July 2023, Agarkar’s current contract expires at the

end of this month. With BCCI regulations capping a selector’s tenure at four years, he is eligible to continue until next September. That would ensure continuity through the ODI World Cup, scheduled to begin in October 2027. However, India’s poor returns in ODIs and the cold war between Agarkar and the BCCI hierarchy over Rohit Sharma’s future in international cricket are likely to feature in the deliberations. The injury-management mechanism at the CoE is another area that has come under criticism from the selection committee and team management. As a result, despite the recent PR overdrive around the CoE, BCCI office-bearers are keen to proactively come

up with a plan for a more effective injury-management system. Scheduling overlaps between key India-A and international assignments and major domestic fixtures are also expected to be discussed. India-A’s shadow tour of New Zealand coinciding with the ODI series against the Kiwis has left little room for adequate Test preparation ahead of the crucial series in November. The poor run of the limited-overs teams in Ireland and England will also come under detailed scrutiny. Saikia had announced a review meeting immediately after the England tour concluded in mid-July, but it could not be convened because of the unavailability of key personnel.



Leading from the front: Tilak guided South’s chase with a breezy half-century. K. MURALI KUMAR

I have always loved red-ball cricket: Tilak

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

For the current generation of cricket fans, Tilak Varma’s image is that of a dashing, short-format batter for India and Mumbai Indians. But over the last four days in the Duleep Trophy, the 23-year-old revealed another face – that of a steely red-ball player. Captaining South Zone in the semifinal versus North, he made an unbeaten 116 from 250 balls to rescue his side from a precarious 80 for five. In the second essay, he was unconquered on 51 (79b) as South chased 181 with ease. “I have always loved red-ball cricket,” Tilak said after his match-winning performance. “I had never dreamt of playing white-ball [cricket] for India, but it’s God’s plan that I have played T20 and One-day for India. But my strength is the red-ball game.” Numbers back this assertion. Though he has featured in just two First Class matches in the last 11 months, the Hyderabad southpaw has scored 1,729

runs at an average of 55.77 and a strike-rate of 52.45 from 24 long-format outings. He also has eight centuries and six half-centuries to his name. “From 2022, I have played a lot of white ball due to IPL and other things, but before that, I have gone through the grind in red ball,” Tilak explained. “No one has seen me since I was 10. It’s always been my strength and it’s there in my blood.” “In the last three-four years, I am not getting enough time because of the international schedule. But whenever I have had a week, or a break, I have played county and domestic cricket.” Tilak is the vice-captain of the Indian T20I team, and leadership spurs him on, he stated. “It gives you more responsibility. Since childhood, I have been captaining Hyderabad, across age categories and Ranji Trophy. “I’ll be thinking, ‘if I am not performing, how will others?’ That extra pressure... I love that. It reflects in my batting too, when the team is under pressure.”

Tilak says he wants to play in the final

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

South Zone skipper Tilak Varma expressed hope that he would be able to play the Duleep Trophy final against East Zone in Chennai starting this Sunday despite the short turnaround time between the marquee contest and the first T20I versus Afghanistan. Tilak, who is India’s T20 vice-captain, will have to finish the final on September 10 and travel to Delhi for the international game scheduled for the 13th. East skipper Ishan Kishan and his deputy Vaibhav Sooryavanshi are also in the same boat. “I want to play in the final,” Tilak told reporters on Wednesday after the triumph over North Zone. “We have two days break in between. But it depends

on the selectors and the management.” Tilak hoped that speedster Vidwath Kaverappa, who didn’t take the field starting from the post-tea session on day three (Tuesday), will be available. “His [left] ankle is slightly swollen, but he can walk and he is also running with a tape. I feel he will be there in the final. But let’s see.” Karnataka stalwart Karun Nair, who scored 699 runs in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy, was benched for the semifinal to accommodate Hyderabad’s K. Himateja. Tilak said it was purely because of team combination. “North had two left-arm spinners, and we wanted a lefty in the middle-order. Himateja is a youngster (24) and has scored decent runs (485). It was very unfortunate for Karun.”

Mumbai, Vadodara to host first women’s CT

Agencies
DUBAI

The International Cricket Council (ICC) announced on Wednesday that the inaugural women’s Champions Trophy 2027 will be held in Mumbai and Vadodara from Feb. 14 to 28. **Top six outfits** Mumbai’s Cricket Club of India (CCI) and the Vadodara International Cricket Stadium will be the venues for the tournament which will bring together six of

the world’s top sides – Australia, England, India, New Zealand, South Africa and Sri Lanka. The teams, which qualified as per their ICC T20I rankings on the July 6 qualification cut-off date, will play in a round-robin league. The top two will progress to the final on February 28. “With a marquee ICC women’s event now taking place every year, we have an opportunity to build greater momentum for the women’s game,” said Jay Shah, ICC chairman.

Moving towards a universal vaccine against pneumonia and meningitis

S. Swaminathan

Sugary shot

Thus, scientists are looking for a universal pneumococcal vaccine that can target all serotypes and prevent these outcomes, which keep the threat of pneumonia, meningitis, and other pneumococcal diseases alive in the population.



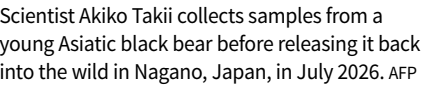
The team shortlisted some candidates and further whittled the list down based on their predicted shapes and stability. From this, the team picked three

Potent antibodies

Third, ZPY-CpG-Ch fully protected

Worthy goal

(S. Swaminathan is a retired professor of biology at BITS-Pilani, Hyderabad, and a former scientist at ICGB, New Delhi. ssn225@gmail.com)



An alternative emerges to check Japan's bear troubles

Agence France-Presse

The process of trapping, tagging, and releasing the animals is part of a pioneering management plan launched in 1995, as authorities realised the bear population was shrinking in the mountainous region in the centre of Japan's Honshu island. And it is becoming part of a model of coexistence in the region that some experts believe is an alternative to the dominant practice of culling the animals in an effort to prevent attacks. "By not killing too many of them, more bears survive to live out their expected lifespan. In that sense, a healthy bear population is being formed," Ms. Taki said of the process, which is paired with other methods intended to keep bears away from humans and monitor their movement.

Even before a cull guidance in Japan was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed; however, several communities are embracing co-existence to prevent attacks

Another group in the area used specially trained Karelian Bear Dogs to scare bears away, and more than 3,000 kilometres of fencing was installed near farms, towns, and along rivers to prevent encounters. Bears who slip through are tranquilised, tagged, and set free far away. The programme has been credited with prompting both a recovery in bear numbers – although the animals are hard to count – and fewer encounters with humans.

There is little sympathy across much of Japan for healthy bear populations. Bears have killed six people nationwide since April 1, after a record 13 fatal attacks last fiscal year, according to the Environment Ministry. Sightings last year doubled the previous record and bears are increasingly entering the outskirts of towns and cities.

The causes are complex and, including variations in the availability of food like acorns, are potentially linked to climate change. The emptying out of rural areas due to depopulation and urbanisation is also leaving forests, farmland, and buffer zones less managed, said Shuichi Kitoh, a Tokyo University professor emeritus of environmental ethics. The government's response has focused largely on culling bears, expanding the process beyond animals in towns to those that wander into buffer zones on the outskirts. Even before the cull guidance was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed – a record 14,000 last fiscal year, or almost 40 a day.

Ms. Takii argued Nagano's coexistence programme offered a different path.

While direct comparisons are difficult, some figures appear to show it has helped limit dangerous encounters. Annual sightings have remained broadly stable at around 1,400 in recent years, while some northern prefectures have recorded sharp increases. Last year, Nagano recorded 11 bear-related incidents, including one death, compared with 59 encounters and four deaths in Akita further north and five fatalities in Iwate.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

It works — but we do not know how

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

The element X is one of the most effective mood stabilisers known, but after having been in use for decades, medical researchers still lack consensus about how exactly it works. Leading theories say it affects inositol signalling and inhibits the GSK-3 enzyme, but they haven't been able to explain all of X's effects. Name X.

QUESTION 2

The general form of _____ induce unconsciousness, amnesia, and immobility during surgery and have been used safely for over 150 years, yet scientists still lack a cohesive theory of how they work at the molecular level. Different forms of the drugs also seem to act through somewhat different molecular routes, yet succeed in inducing unconsciousness. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 3

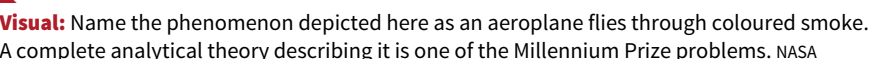
of explaining conventional superconductivity. However, high-temperature superconductors that scientists found in compounds called Y in the 1980s still lack a complete and cogent theoretical explanation for how they superconduct. Name Y.

QUESTION #4

_____, a.k.a. Glucophage, is used worldwide as a first-line drug in the treatment of type II diabetes, yet scientists are still figuring out how it lowers blood glucose levels. Some leading ideas include the drug's effects on the gut microbiome and the mitochondrial complex I. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION #5

At sub-anesthetic doses, name the drug derived from phencyclidine — and which was used as surgical anesthesia during the Vietnam War — that can lift severe depression within hours, in dramatic contrast to the drugs called SSRIs. As with other therapies on this list, its full mechanism of action is still unclear.



Answers to August 27 quiz:

1. Businessman who drilled world's first commercial oil well – Ans: **Edwin Drake**
2. Substance yielded along with crude oil, used to be flared off – Ans: **Natural gas**
3. Components of hydraulic fracturing fluid – Ans: **Water and sand**
4. Valve systems that prevented uncontrolled gushing of oil – Ans: **Blowout preventers**
5. Machines called ‘nodding donkeys’ to mechanically lift oil – Ans: **Pump jacks**

Visual: **Paul Thomas Anderson**
directed **There Will Be Blood**

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For feedback and

suggestions
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